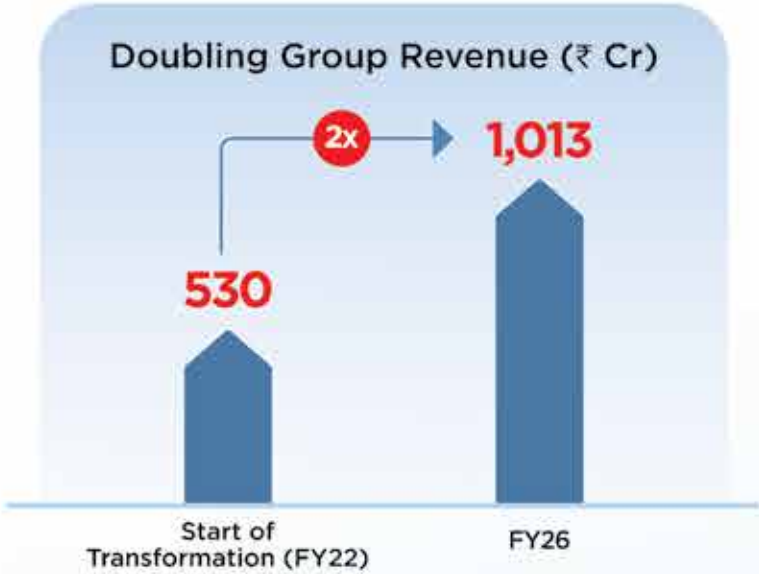


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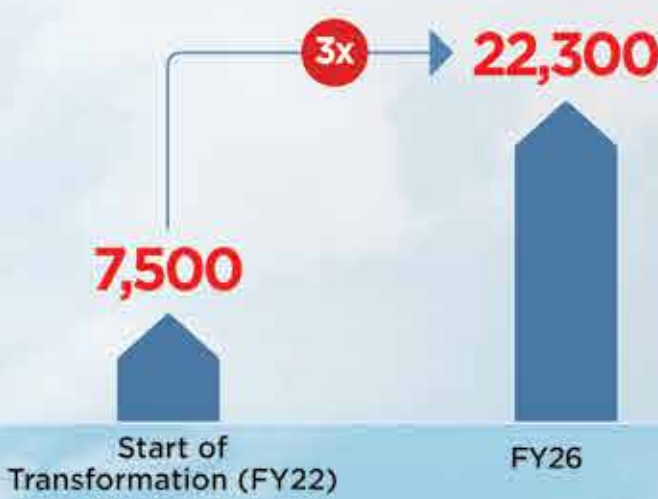


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(Cumulative Student Count)





CITY: Pg 5

TB fight needs everyone: CM



NATION: Pg 9

Registration of Births & Deaths Bill cleared



FILM: Pg 14

'Real women are contradictory'

CRACKDOWN ON DIGITAL ARREST SCAMS

SC tightens cyber fraud framework, asks RBI to circulate SOP in 4 weeks

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday issued a series of nationwide directions to strengthen the country's response to cyber-enabled financial frauds, asking the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to prepare a standard operating procedure (SOP) within four weeks for dealing with bank accounts linked to cyber fraud, including mule accounts. The court also directed states, Union Territories (UTs), law enforcement agencies, banks and other authorities to speed up grievance redressal, improve recovery of defrauded money and step up public awareness as it noted that existing measures require wider adoption



and faster implementation.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana passed the directions

while hearing the suo motu case, In Re: Victims of Digital Arrest Related to Forged Documents. After examining consolidated status reports and hearing

Attorney General R Venkataramani on behalf of the Centre, the bench said, "While the progress reported at this stage is appreciable, the mechanisms already

put in place require wider adoption, faster implementation, and continued follow-up."

The court directed the RBI to prepare and circulate

the SOP within four weeks for handling mule accounts and other bank accounts linked to money laundering and cyber-enabled fraud. It also asked the central bank to provide copies of the final SOP to the Registrars General of all High Courts so that the guidelines are available across the judicial system.

The bench instructed all states, UTs and law enforcement agencies to ensure the "expeditious adoption and operationalisation" of the Grievance Redressal Module and the Money Restoration Module developed under the Ministry of Home Affairs' Standard Operating Procedure for the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal (NCRP).

Continued on P6

CLOSER LOOK

- » SOP will cover mule accounts and cyber fraud-linked bank accounts
- » RBI must share the SOP with Registrars General of all High Courts
- » Court seeks faster adoption of cyber fraud grievance and money restoration modules
- » States and UTs ordered to spread awareness about both victim support modules

- » Victims should ordinarily use grievance mechanism before approaching courts, bench says
- » Legal remedies remain available despite use of grievance redressal mechanism
- » Authorities must submit state-wise and bank-wise cyber fraud grievance data
- » Reports must include restoration orders and amounts returned to victims

ONLY 18 STATES HAVE STATE CYBER CRIME COORDINATION CENTRES, COURT NOTES

India calls PoK local polls 'complete farce', says 90 civilians killed

Asks Pak to dismantle terror infra

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: India on Tuesday dismissed the recently held local body elections in Pakistan occupied Kashmir (PoK) as a "complete farce", saying the electoral exercise cannot conceal the ongoing unrest in the region, where at least 90 civilians have been killed in a continuing crackdown by Pakistani forces since June.

Responding to a question during the Ministry of External Affairs' weekly media briefing, MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said public protests and civilian deaths reflected the real situation in PoK rather than the elections. "This so-called local election in PoK is a complete farce. The real happening is that of public protests and wanton

TAKEAWAYS

- » MEA says elections cannot hide protests, killings and repression in Pakistan occupied Kashmir
- » New Delhi accuses Pakistan of using elections to manufacture legitimacy amid public unrest
- » India urges global community to hold Pakistan accountable over rights situation in PoK

killings by Pakistani forces. Such hollow exercises cannot hide reality," Jaiswal said.

He said at least 90 civilians have lost their lives since June as Pakistani authorities continued

Continued on P6

Missing three cast shadow over rebel camp unity



Suvendu holds meet with NCPI defectors

MPOST BUREAU

KOLKATA: About a fortnight after 20 rebel Trinamool Congress MPs crossed over to the little-known Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI), now, an NDA ally, the numbers at the ruling coalition's 'Mangal Milan' meeting have refused to add up.

For the second consecutive Tuesday, the saga continued with only 17 of the

20 rebel MPs showing up at the NDA meet, while Abu Tahir Khan, Khalilur Rahman and Yusuf Pathan stayed away once again. All three, however, later attended the meeting with Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari at Banga Bhawan in Delhi.

The absence from the NDA meet came as Abu Tahir Khan publicly declared that he would "neither remain with the NDA nor join the

Continued on P6

'NO THIRD-PARTY INSURANCE COVER, NO FUEL'

SC proposes fuel ban for uninsured vehicles

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday proposed a major step to improve compliance with mandatory motor insurance, directing the Centre to prepare a pilot project under which vehicles without valid third-party insurance could be denied fuel at petrol pumps until the required

cover is obtained.

A bench of Justices Sanjay Karol and Prashant Kumar Mishra said the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI), in consultation with the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH), should develop the pilot scheme. The court suggested that the system use Automatic Number Plate

Recognition (ANPR) cameras to verify insurance status.

"As deliberated upon in court, the IRDA in consultation with the MoRTH... evolve a pilot project whereby fuel for vehicles be linked with valid insurance status. In the absence thereof, the vehicle concerned would be refused fuel at petrol pumps, until such time that valid insurance

is obtained," the bench said.

The court noted that the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas had, in principle, no objection to the proposal. It said denying fuel would help identify uninsured or unregistered vehicles while encouraging owners to comply with the law under Section 146 of the Motor Vehicles Act.

Continued on P6

AI Phuket-Delhi flight suddenly loses 300 ft altitude; 15 injured



A staff member is present with an injured passenger on a stretcher after several passengers, including crew members, got injured

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: An Air India flight from Phuket to Delhi encountered severe turbulence on Tuesday morning, causing the aircraft to suddenly lose around 300 feet in altitude and leaving at least 15 people injured, according to officials. The Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) has launched an investigation into the incident.

The Airbus A320, operating flight AI2379, landed

safely at Delhi airport at around 11.30 am. The aircraft was carrying 134 passengers and eight crew members.

Sources said 15 people, including 11 passengers and four cabin crew members, sustained injuries and were shifted to different hospitals. A senior DGCA official said that the Pilot In Command reported one cabin crew member suffered severe injuries, another crew member was injured, and a few passengers

Continued on P6

DMK's Udhayanidhi arrested for 'double-meaning' remark, released

MPOST BUREAU

CHENNAI: Former Tamil Nadu Deputy Chief Minister and Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin was arrested by Thanjavur police in Chennai on Tuesday in connection with an alleged "double-meaning" remark linked to actor Trisha and later released on station bail after being questioned at Sengipatti Police Sta-

tion near Thanjavur. The arrest, a day before the Tamil Nadu Assembly's Budget session begins, sparked protests by DMK workers across the state and drew criticism from several political leaders. Udhayanidhi was taken into custody from his Neelankarai residence around 11 am and released at about 8.10 pm after questioning.

Continued on P6

Monsoon havoc continues

18 more die, IMD warns of more rain

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Heavy rain continued to batter large parts of the country on Tuesday, leaving at least 18 people dead during the day, disrupting normal life, flooding villages and keeping disaster response agencies on alert across several states. Kerala remained the worst-hit by the ongoing spell, where the overall rain toll since August 1 climbed to 25, while two more people died in Assam floods and 14 people were killed in lightning strikes in Jharkhand on Tuesday. Fresh downpours also affected Karnataka, Rajasthan, Himachal Pradesh, Haryana, Punjab and Odisha, while authorities in Gujarat stepped up disease prevention measures in flood-hit areas and Maharashtra announced an enhanced compensation package for affected residents.

In Kerala, relentless rain since August 1 has claimed 25 lives, left four people missing and injured 10 others, according to the state government. A total of 52 houses have been destroyed and 565 partially damaged, while more than 18,000 people have been shifted to over 400 relief

CLOSER LOOK

- » Jharkhand reports 14 lightning deaths, with Giridih accounting for nine fatalities
- » Kerala rain toll since August 1 rises to 25; over 18,000 people shifted to 400-plus relief camps
- » Assam flood toll reaches 89 after two more deaths; 1.22 lakh people remain affected

camps across the state.

Pathanamthitta has the largest number of evacuees with 7,852 people in camps, followed by Kottayam (5,288) and Alappuzha (2,651), where several low-lying areas remain submerged.

Kerala received 205.8 mm of rainfall between August 1 and 4 against the normal 73.2 mm, recording an excess of 181 per cent. The India Meteorological Department (IMD) issued a red alert for Pathanamthitta, Kottayam, Idukki, Ernakulam, Kozhikode,

Continued on P6

Blue-strip labels for antimicrobial medicines soon to curb misuse

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Centre has proposed making blue-strip labels mandatory on all antimicrobial medicines to help pharmacists identify them easily and encourage their responsible use, as part of efforts to tackle the growing threat of antimicrobial resistance (AMR). The proposal was shared in the Rajya Sabha on Tuesday by Minister of State for Health Prataprao Jadhav, who said the government has taken several coordinated steps to address the public health challenge.

In a written reply, Jadhav said a draft notification to amend the Drugs Rules, 1945, was issued on January 21, 2026. The proposed amendment introduces blue-strip labelling for antimicrobial medicines to make them easier to identify at pharmacy counters and promote their judicious use. He said the government is implementing the National Action Plan on

Continued on P6

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GREATER NOIDA

Factory wall collapse kills two firefighters

DIPIKA KIROLA

GREATER NOIDA: Two firefighters were killed and three others injured after a factory wall and a heavy iron beam collapsed on them while they were battling a major fire at an electronic chip manufacturing unit in Greater Noida's Ecotech-3 industrial area early Tuesday. Nearly 500 workers on the night shift were evacuated safely from the building before the collapse, officials said.

According to the fire department, the blaze broke out around 3.30 am at ILJIN Electronics, where electronic chips used in household appliances, including washing machines, are manufactured. Six fire tenders were initially rushed to the spot, but additional vehicles were deployed as flames rapidly engulfed the first floor of the two-storey factory.

Chief Fire Officer Pradeep Kumar Chaubey said the fire-fighting operation was in its final stages when, around 4.15 am, a side wall and a heavy iron beam suddenly gave way, trap-



“Rescue teams pulled the firefighters out and rushed them to Yatharth Hospital in Bsirakh”

ping five firefighters beneath the debris.

Rescue teams pulled the firefighters out and rushed them to Yatharth Hospital in Bsirakh, where Fireman Rohit Yadav, 32, and Chief Fire Station Driver Teerathpal Singh, 48, were declared dead. Three others — Rajpal Singh, Manish Kumar and Amit Kumar — sustained injuries and are

stated to be out of danger.

Fire Station Officer Ajay Kumar Singh said the fire originated in a testing laboratory on the first floor. The factory's alarm system alerted employees, allowing all workers to evacuate before the blaze intensified. Firefighters were carrying out cooling operations after bringing the fire under control when the structure collapsed without warning, he said.

Police Commissioner Lakshmi Singh visited the injured firefighters at the hospital and met the families of the deceased.

She said a detailed inquiry had been ordered and legal action would be initiated if any violation of safety norms or construction standards, or any negligence by the factory management, was established.

She also directed that the building undergo a structural audit by the Public Works Department to determine whether structural weakness contributed to the collapse.

GZB: Kanwariya killed in NH-9 road accident, another dies after snakebite

DIPIKA KIROLA

GHAZIABAD: Ghaziabad witnessed two separate tragedies involving Kanwariyas on Monday night, with a 20-year-old devotee killed in a road accident on NH-9 in Indrapuram and another pilgrim dying after a snakebite at a Kanwar camp in Muradnagar. Two others were injured in the incidents, one of whom remains in critical condition.

The road accident occurred on the NH-9 stretch running parallel to the Delhi-Meerut Expressway in the Indrapuram area. Police identified the deceased as Deepanshu, 20, a resident of Chhalera village in Noida. He was travelling to Haridwar with three friends to collect Ganga water and was expected to return on August 5.

According to police officials, the accident took place



late Monday night when Deepanshu's motorcycle was overtaking a truck. During the manoeuvre, the motorcycle was allegedly hit by a speeding unidentified truck. The impact was severe, killing Deepanshu on the spot, while his pillion rider sustained minor injuries.

The accident triggered protests by the victim's family members and fellow Kanwariyas, who blocked NH-9, causing a long traffic jam stretching towards the Delhi border. Senior police officers, including ACP Indrapuram Sury-

Police sent the body for postmortem and launched a search for the unidentified truck driver

abali Maurya, reached the spot and persuaded the protesters to disperse, following which traffic movement resumed.

Police sent the body for postmortem and launched a search for the unidentified truck driver. CCTV footage from nearby areas is being examined to establish the identity of the vehicle and its driver.

In a separate incident, two Kanwariyas were bitten by a snake while sleeping at the Didauli Kanwar camp in Muradnagar around 11 pm on Monday. They were returning

to Rajasthan after collecting Ganga water from Haridwar and had stopped at the camp for the night.

The victims were identified as Sandeep, 45, a resident of Bahajod village in Alwar district, and Lal Chand, 65. Their companion, Jai Singh, said fellow devotees rushed the two men to MMG Hospital in the early hours of Tuesday after the snakebite.

Doctors at MMG Hospital said both pilgrims were brought in critical condition and were referred to a higher medical centre after receiving initial treatment. However, Sandeep died before reaching the referral hospital. Lal Chand was shifted to a hospital in Delhi, where he continues to receive treatment.

Sandeep's family later took his body home without a postmortem.

NOTTO app to track recipients, streamline organ allocation

SHIVANGI SHUKLA

NEW DELHI: The National Organ and Tissue Transplant Organisation (NOTTO) has launched a real-time portal and mobile app to make India's organ transplant system more transparent, efficient and equitable.

The platform will create a nationwide waiting list, provide real-time updates on recipients and allow hospitals and state bodies to raise "super urgent" requests.

It will also enable organ allocation tracking, donor matching and recording of transplant outcomes. India recorded 20,138 organ transplants in 2025, including 16,612 from living donors and 3,526 from deceased donors.

Biker dies after crashing into parked car; 1 injured

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: A 25-year-old motorcyclist was killed and his pillion rider injured after their KTM motorcycle rammed into a parked car near Second Pushpa Road towards Akshardham in northeast Delhi's Shastri Park area on Tuesday afternoon, police said.

The police were alerted to the incident through a PCR call received at Shastri Park police station. According to officials, information about the accident was received at around 1.15 pm, following which a police team reached the spot and found that the KTM motorcycle had collided with a parked car.

The motorcycle rider was identified as Syed Aman Ali, 25, son of Majid Ali and a resident of Chudiwalan in Delhi. He sustained serious injuries and was taken to Jag Praveesh Chandra (JPC) Hospital, where doctors declared him dead on arrival.

The pillion rider, Syed Mohd Faiz, 25, also sustained serious injuries. Some passers-by took him to JPC Hospital before the police arrived. His condition was not immediately known.



Police said the motorcycle's front end was severely damaged in the collision, while the parked vehicle was also damaged. A forensic team from the Crime Branch was called to the scene to collect evidence and assist in determining the circumstances leading to the accident.

Police are probing the motorcycle's speed, road conditions and the possibility of negligence, along with other aspects of the case. They are also examining witness statements and other available evidence to establish the exact cause of the accident.

A case has been registered under Sections 281, 125(a) and 106(1) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), police said. The motorcycle and the other vehicle involved have been taken into police custody as part of the investigation.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has arrested 254 foreign nationals in drug trafficking cases in the National Capital Region (NCR) since 2024, with narcotics worth over Rs 40.53 crore seized from them, the government informed the Lok Sabha on Tuesday.

It also said action has been taken against 63 landlords who rented 103 foreign nationals in their premises without mandatory tenant verification.

In a written reply to the Lok Sabha, Minister of State for Home Affairs Nityanand Rai said that, according to Delhi Police, 254 foreign nationals residing in the NCR were arrested in cases related to illegal trafficking of narcotic drugs between 2024 and June 30, 2026.

The arrests include foreign nationals, including those of Nigerian origin, apprehended from areas such as Khanpur Extension, Deoli, Sangam Vihar, Mehrauli, Hauz Rani, Uttam Nagar and adjoining parts of west Delhi.

The year-wise data showed that 40 foreign nationals were



arrested in 2024, 35 in 2025 and 15 during the first half of 2026 in the specified areas.

The seizures included heroin, cocaine, amphetamine, MDMA, methamphetamine, ecstasy, ganja and charas, with the estimated value pegged at Rs 12.75 crore in 2024, Rs 14.27 crore in 2025 and Rs 13.50 crore up to June 30 this year.

The minister informed that 103 foreign nationals were found residing in rented accommodation without mandatory tenant verification during the period. Action has been taken against 63 landlords, while tenant verification, including of foreign nationals, is carried out regularly by the Delhi Police to maintain security and law and order.

In a separate reply to a ques-

tion seeking to know if Haryana has been identified as a key transit route for interstate narcotics trafficking between Punjab, Delhi, Rajasthan and hilly states, the minister noted that no state can be categorised as a permanent transit route, as trafficking patterns remain dynamic and are continuously evaluated based on intelligence inputs and enforcement actions.

"The issue is also reviewed through the Narco-Coordination Centre (NCORD) mechanism and actionable intelligence is shared with the concerned enforcement agencies for coordinated action under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act," he said.

The government plans dedicated Darknet and Cryptocurrency Cells in all Anti-Narcotics Task Forces under its 2026-2029 narcotics vision. The NCB is also using AI, cyber experts and digital forensics to target online drug trafficking, cryptocurrency transactions and organised networks, alongside stronger financial investigations and international cooperation.

Complaint against teen over abusive remarks against PM withdrawn, family not at residence

NOIDA: The complainant in the case against a 15-year-old girl over her abusive remarks against Prime Minister Narendra Modi at the CJP protest has withdrawn the complaint, saying that she no longer wished to pursue it as the teenager had apologised and the PM had forgiven her.

Supreme Court lawyer Smriti Singh, who lives in Ghaziabad's Vasundhara and had lodged the complaint, told PTI on Tuesday evening that the FIR was initially filed against eight girls, with the Noida teen being the first among them.

She said the zero FIR was registered on July 29 based on a complaint lodged by her at the Expressway police station in Noida.

The case was registered under sections 352 (insult with intent to provoke breach of the peace), 353(1) (statements conducing to public mischief) and 356(1) (defamation) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), she said.

"After the prime minister appealed for forgiveness, the girls, including the Noida girl, uploaded apology videos. I had also posted a video saying that if the girls apologised, I would withdraw my complaint," Singh said.

She said the remaining girls also apologised subsequently and that she has withdrawn her complaints in all eight cases.

"Since the prime minister forgave them, I also do not

want to pursue the matter further. I have communicated my decision to Delhi Police and Crime Branch," Singh told PTI. At a housing society in Sector 168 where the teenager and her mother lived, security guards and maintenance staff told PTI that the two were not home.

"The family had remained withdrawn since the video surfaced. Personnel from Delhi and Noida police had visited their residence on a few occasions," a security guard told PTI.

Noida Police said the family had not reported any harassment and may have temporarily moved to Faridabad, while the zero FIR remains under examination by Delhi Police. PTI

Cops bust interstate gunrunning racket, recover 18 firearms

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Eight suspects linked with an interstate arms smuggling syndicate, including the alleged kingpin, have been arrested and 18 illegal firearms, additional magazines and live cartridges have been seized following an extensive operation by Delhi Police's Special Cell, an official said on Tuesday.

The accused were allegedly part of a network that procured sophisticated semi-automatic pistols and country-made firearms from Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh and supplied them to criminals in Delhi-NCR and adjoining areas, police said.

"The syndicate used encrypted social media applications, virtual numbers and fake online identities to coordinate with suppliers, traffickers and buyers while concealing identities of its members," a senior police officer said.

The arrestees have been identified as Harish Chandra (24), Pritpal Singh (24), Shishpal Singh alias Yash Chaudhary (26), Kuldeep Sagar (20), Agesh Kumar (25), Noor Mohammed alias Taslim (36), Mohammed Shan (19) and Vikram Singh (36).

Police said the operation was carried out on the basis of specific intelligence developed over several weeks regarding movement of illegal firearms into Delhi-NCR.

"During the operation, the team recovered 12 semi-automatic pistols, five country-made pistols, one revolver, 10 additional magazines, five live



9 mm prohibited cartridges, besides one live cartridge and an iron sickle from one of the accused," the officer said.

He further said the investigation began on July 5 when Harish Chandra was apprehended with eight semi-automatic pistols and eight magazines allegedly smuggled from Madhya Pradesh.

During interrogation, he disclosed that he and his brother were transporting illegal firearms at the direction of the syndicate's alleged kingpin Shishpal Singh, police said.

Based on his disclosure, police arrested Pritpal Singh and later tracked down Shishpal from Ballabhgarh in Haryana, recovering another illegal pistol from his rented accommodation.

According to police, Shishpal had been involved in illegal arms trade for nearly three years and had established a network of suppliers, couriers and traffickers operating across multiple states.

Police arrested several accused and recovered pistols and ammunition, alleging the syndicate sourced firearms from Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh for distribution across Delhi-NCR.

Cyber fraud syndicate busted

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police have busted an interstate cyber fraud syndicate allegedly involved in task-based scams and fake cryptocurrency investments, arresting six people from Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh.

The accused allegedly cheated a Delhi resident of Rs 4.29 lakh by promising commissions and cryptocurrency returns. Police traced the money through bank records, UPI transactions and CCTV footage, leading to arrests in Jaipur and Indore. MPOST

Placement fraud racket busted

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Seven persons have been apprehended for allegedly operating a fake placement agency here and cheating job seekers on the pretext of providing employment, police said on Tuesday.

According to the police, the accused were running an unregistered placement agency in west Delhi's Uttam Nagar area, and luring job aspirants through online employment portals by posing as HR executives.

The matter came to light following a complaint from

a Karol Bagh resident, who alleged he had received a message from a person claiming to be an HR executive in response to an online job application.

He was called for an interview at the agency's office in Uttam Nagar on July 25, where he was allegedly asked to pay Rs 4,800 as registration and account opening charges. He was assured that the amount would be refunded after he joined the job.

"However, neither was any job provided nor was the money refunded, and the mobile numbers used to contact him later became unreachable," a senior officer said.

Based on the complaint, a case was registered on August 1. During the probe, police analysed mobile phone records, digital payment trails and beneficiary bank accounts before raiding the placement agency's 'office' at Jeevan Park in Uttam Nagar.

Police arrested seven people, including alleged mastermind Preeti Malhotra, for a fake job racket that collected Rs 3,000-4,000 from candidates through sham interviews. Five cybercrime complaints were linked to the accused.

8.8 MILLION MT OF WASTE PROCESSED

MCD's Okhla cleanup enters critical phase with fresh waste still arriving

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: At Okhla, the effort to bring down one of Delhi's most prominent waste mountains is entering a critical phase. The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) is racing to process the remaining waste while preventing fresh garbage from rebuilding what it has spent years removing.

A total of 8.8 million metric tonnes (MT) of waste has so far undergone bio mining and bioremediation at the Okhla landfill, officials said. Around 8.4 million MT of waste accumulated up to 2025 has been processed, while approximately 1.5 million MT of waste generated over the past one-and-a-half years remains to be cleared.

MCD Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar inspected the landfill on Tuesday and



reviewed the ongoing operations. He directed officials to accelerate the disposal of the remaining waste as well as the fresh waste arriving at the site. He also ordered the paving of the access road to facilitate the movement of heavy vehicles.

Spread over nearly 62 acres, the Okhla landfill has been undergoing biomining since 2019 following directions from the National Green Tribunal to tackle Delhi's legacy waste dumpsites. The process involves excavating and

mechanically segregating old waste into recyclable, combustible and inert material. Combustible fractions can be processed into refuse-derived fuel, while inert material is recovered for reuse.

The pace of biomining at Okhla has increased substantially, with processing capacity reported to have risen from around 6,000 MT to nearly 10,000 MT a day. One of the site's two major waste mounds has also been levelled.

But the challenge extends

beyond clearing the existing waste. Fresh garbage continues to reach the site, raising the prospect of replacing the waste being removed. The MCD is developing a facility with a proposed capacity of 1,400 MT a day to process fresh waste, with the project targeted for completion in October.

The civic body is also working on a Construction and Demolition waste processing facility at Okhla and plans to expand waste-processing infrastructure to reduce dependence on landfills.

The latest deadline for Okhla's clearance is October 2026, following several earlier extensions.

For the MCD, therefore, the task is no longer merely to dismantle an old garbage mountain. It is to ensure that the mountain does not return.

EOW nabs loan facilitator in Rs 3 cr property fraud

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police's Economic Offences Wing (EOW) has arrested a 59-year-old loan facilitator for allegedly orchestrating a property loan fraud of around Rs 3 crore using forged title documents, impersonation and shell companies to dupe a non-banking financial company (NBFC), officials said on Tuesday.

The accused, Maneesh Kumar, was arrested from Laxmi Nagar on July 14. The case was registered on a complaint by a private finance company, which alleged that a housing loan of about Rs 3 crore was fraudulently obtained for a property in Anand Vihar.

The EOW said a November 2022 sale deed was based on forged documents and executed by a woman impersonating the genuine owner. She allegedly executed two fraudulent sale deeds for the same property within 25 days.

Investigators alleged Kumar posed as the buyer, used forged identities and documents to secure loans, and created shell firms to divert the proceeds. He also allegedly falsely projected a deceased woman as his wife and co-applicant. Police recovered mobile phones, SIM cards, digital signature certificates, cheque books, POS machines and other documents. Further investigation is underway. MPOST

MORE THAN 71,000 COMPLETE FINAL REGISTRATION

Over 3L register for Lakshmi in 4 days

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government's flagship Delhi Lakshmi Yojana has witnessed a strong response from women across the national capital, with more than 3 lakh registrations recorded within four days of the launch of its online portal. According to official figures available till 8 pm on Tuesday, 3,00,709 women had registered, while 71,411 applicants had successfully completed the final submission process.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta had formally launched the scheme and its dedicated online portal on August 1. Officials had said that the portal attracted over 33,700 registrations within the first 12 hours, with nearly 2,000 applications being fully submitted on the opening day itself.

The scheme promises Rs 2,500 per month to eligible women but has been designed to promote both immediate

financial support and long-term savings rather than functioning as a conventional cash transfer programme.

Speaking at the launch, Gupta said the initiative fulfils the BJP government's commitment to strengthening the financial independence of women in Delhi. She also noted that while the Cabinet had initially approved the programme as the Mahila Samridhhi Yojana, it was later renamed Delhi Lakshmi Yojana to reflect its broader objective of promoting women's dignity, prosperity and economic security.

The Chief Minister had announced that the scheme would initially remain in force for three years and is expected to benefit around 17 lakh women across the city.

Under the programme, beneficiaries can choose between two financial models. In the first option, Rs 1,000 is credited every month to a

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The scheme promises Rs 2,500 per month to eligible women but has been designed to promote both immediate financial support and long-term savings rather than functioning as a conventional cash transfer programme
- » Under the programme, beneficiaries can choose between two financial models
- » In the first option, Rs 1,000 is credited every month to a Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) wallet for routine
- » The second option allows the entire Rs 2,500 to be transferred into an RD or FD account each month, enabling beneficiaries to build savings and earn interest over time

deposited in a recurring or fixed deposit account

» The second option allows the entire Rs 2,500 to be transferred into an RD or FD account each month, enabling beneficiaries to build savings and earn interest over time



Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) wallet for routine

household expenses, while the remaining Rs 1,500 is deposited

in a recurring or fixed deposit account. The second option allows the entire Rs 2,500 to be transferred into an RD or FD account each month, enabling beneficiaries to build savings and earn interest over time.

To ensure that government assistance is used for essential household needs, the CBDC wallet will operate with a digital negative list. Expenditure on alcohol, tobacco products, narcotic substances, gambling, betting, lottery tickets and other prohibited items will not be permitted.

The government has made the scheme completely digital, with the portal handling applications, document uploads, eligibility verification, approvals, banking integration, CBDC transfers and SMS notifications. Officials said every application will undergo a four-stage verification process, beginning with scrutiny by the District Programme Management Unit, followed by verification by the

District Women and Child Development Officer. The final approval will be granted by the District-Level Approval, Monitoring and Grievance Redressal Committee.

Authorities said applicants' details will be verified through Aadhaar authentication, Delhi voter records, family income, electricity consumption, vehicle ownership, pension records, government employment status and other eligibility parameters. Any false declaration may lead to cancellation of benefits, recovery of the amount paid and legal action.

To qualify, the applicant must be the eldest eligible woman in the family, aged between 21 and 60 years. The annual family income should not exceed Rs.2.5 lakh, and either the applicant or her parents or husband must have been residing in Delhi for at least 10 years. The beneficiary must also be a registered voter in the national capital.



TB fight needs everyone: CM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Calling tuberculosis elimination a fight that requires the participation of every citizen, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday urged elected representatives, corporates, social organisations and residents to actively join the Nikshay Mitra initiative, saying public participation is the key to making Delhi and the country TB-free.

Addressing a sensitisation workshop for public representatives under the TB-Free India Campaign at the Delhi Secretariat, Gupta said the campaign has grown beyond a government programme into a nationwide movement. The event was organised by the National Health Mission and the Delhi State Health Mission.

"Under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the TB-Free India Campaign has evolved beyond a government programme into a nationwide movement driven by public participation. The target can be achieved within the stipulated timeline only through the active participation of every citizen," the Chief Minister said.

Highlighting Delhi's progress, Gupta said the Capital has consistently achieved over 95 per cent of its annual TB patient notification target set by the Centre. Stressing that tuberculosis is curable, she said timely diagnosis and completion of treatment can ensure full recovery.

"TB is nothing to be ashamed of, but a disease that

Hospitals and doctors alone cannot achieve this goal; every section of society must contribute — CM

can be completely cured with timely treatment. Hospitals and doctors alone cannot achieve this goal; every section of society must contribute," she said, urging MPs, MLAs and councillors to spread awareness, encourage early testing and motivate patients to complete treatment.

The Chief Minister also appealed to industries, resident welfare associations, corporate bodies, religious institutions and citizens to become Nikshay Mitras, volunteers who provide nutritional and social support to TB patients.

According to the government, more than 3,300 Nikshay Mitras are currently supporting TB patients in Delhi, helping distribute over 1.2 lakh nutritional food baskets. Gupta said a Nikshay Mitra offers "not only nutritional support but also dignity, confidence and reassurance that society stands with the patient."

During the programme, the Chief Minister reviewed an exhibition and awareness stalls showcasing the TB elimination campaign, including the Nikshay Mitra initiative, and directed officials to expand the campaign to every ward and Assembly constituency.



'Kanwariyas' cover themselves as they move amid rainfall, at India Gate PFI

DDA extends housing schemes' booking till Aug 31

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) has extended the booking period for flats under its Nagrik Awaas Yojana 2026 (FCFS) and Karmayogi Awaas Yojana 2025 (FCFS) till August 31, 2026, according to separate circulars issued on July 31.

Under the Nagrik Awaas Yojana 2026, launched through a January 23 circular, DDA is offering HIG, MIG, LIG and EWS flats in Narela and LIG flats in Siras Pur. An additional 1,944 flats in Sector G-7/G-8, Narela, were offered through a March 18 circular, with booking commencing on March 27. The extension will allow prospective buyers to apply for both previously offered flats and newly added flats in Narela. DDA has advised prospective buyers to complete booking at the earliest to avoid last-minute inconvenience.

Separately, the Karmayogi Awaas Yojana 2025 is for serving and retired employees of the Central Government, State Government, PSUs, PSBs, Local Bodies, Autonomous Bodies and Government Universities. Under the scheme, flats were initially offered in Pocket-9 and subsequently in Pocket-6, Sector A1-A4, Narela. DDA has also added 1,552 flats in Pocket-13, Sector A1-A4, Narela, under the scheme through its May 21 circular, with booking for these flats opening from June 1. In view of the addition of new inventory in Pocket-13 and the continued response to the scheme, DDA has extended the booking period. Eligible applicants can now book flats in Pockets 6, 9 and 13, Sector A1-A4, Narela, during the extended period. Both extensions have been issued with the approval of the Competent Authority.

Dwarka Golf goes popular

SHIVANGI SHUKLA

NEW DELHI: The Lifetime Membership registration for the DDA's Dwarka Golf Course, opened on the directions of Delhi Lieutenant Governor Sardar Taranjit Singh Sandhu, has received an overwhelming response, with 856 applications received against 850 memberships within just 11 days of the registration process.

The Non Government Category, receiving 636 applications against 600 memberships, while the Government Category has received 220 applications against 250 memberships. With the registration window open for two months from July 21, 2026, both categories are likely to be oversubscribed by the close of the registration period. DDA is offering 600 Lifetime Memberships under the Non-Government Category and 250 under the Government Category. Applicants can also opt for three year and five year memberships. The registration fee is Rs.2,500 and is non-refundable. Following scrutiny, successful



applicants will have to deposit the applicable membership fee online within 30 days of receiving the offer.

Where eligible applications exceed available memberships, allotment will be through a fully computerised draw of lots after the registration period closes. Applicants have been advised to submit only one application, as multiple applications may lead to rejection.

The Lifetime Membership fee is Rs 7.50 lakh for the Non-Government Category and Rs 3.50 lakh for the Government Category. Three year memberships cost Rs 2.50 lakh and Rs

1.20 lakh respectively, while five-year memberships are priced at Rs 4.50 lakh and Rs 1.80 lakh.

Inaugurated in 2024, the 18 hole championship course spans 158 acres in Sector 24, Dwarka, across 7,377 yards. It has a 375 yard driving range with 52 bays, clubhouse, restaurant, swimming pool, sauna and steam facilities, among other amenities. A Golf Academy is also being established as a Centre of Excellence.

DDA currently has 18 Sports Complexes, four Mini Sports Complexes and three Public Golf Courses across Delhi.

Rain brings relief

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Rain lashed parts of Delhi on Tuesday, bringing relief from humid conditions as several areas recorded moderate showers during the day, with Ayanagar receiving nearly 50 mm of rainfall, the highest among the city's weather stations.

According to the India Meteorological Department (IMD), between 8.30 am and 5.30 pm on Tuesday, Ayanagar again recorded the highest rainfall at 49.3 mm, followed by Safdarjung at 9.4 mm, Palam at 8.1 mm, Lodhi Road at 3.7 mm and the Ridge at 1.5 mm.

In the last 24 hours ending at 8.30 am on Tuesday, Ayanagar received the highest cumulative rainfall at 23.6 mm. Safdarjung, Palam and the Ridge recorded trace rainfall, while Lodhi Road did not receive any rainfall.

The maximum temperature at Safdarjung, the city's base station, settled at 33.5 degrees Celsius, 0.7 notches below normal, while the minimum was 27.4 degrees Celsius, 0.5 notches above normal.

Palam recorded a maximum of 31.6 degrees Celsius, 2.8 notches below normal, and a minimum of 24.8 degrees Celsius, 2 notches below normal. At Lodhi Road, the maxi-

mum settled at 33.2 degrees Celsius, 0.2 notches above normal, and the minimum was 26.8 degrees Celsius, 0.8 notches above normal. The Ridge station recorded a maximum of 32.1 degrees Celsius, 1.9 notches below normal, and a minimum of 24.9 degrees Celsius, 1.3 notches below normal.

Ayanagar logged a maximum of 30.6 degrees Celsius, 3.4 notches below normal, and a minimum of 25.6 degrees Celsius, 0.8 notches below normal. The IMD has forecast a generally cloudy sky with moderate rain on Wednesday and issued a yellow alert for the national capital. With a yellow alert in place, the maximum is likely to settle around 33 degrees Celsius, while the minimum will be at 24 degrees Celsius, the IMD said.

The weather office has forecast fairly widespread to widespread rainfall over Delhi, Haryana, Chandigarh, Punjab and east Uttar Pradesh between August 4 and August 6. Rain activity is likely to continue over Delhi till August 10.

The city's air quality remained in the "satisfactory" category for the fourth consecutive day this month, with an Air Quality Index of 64 at 4 pm, according to the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB).

City Briefs

GOVT PLANS PERMANENT CHHATH GHAT ALONG MUNGESHPUR DRAIN IN N DELHI

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government is planning to develop a permanent Chhath ghat along both banks of the Mungeshpur drain in outer north Delhi to facilitate large-scale Chhath Puja celebrations, officials said on Tuesday.

NDMC READIES FOR TIRANGA YATRA

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) is planning to organise a Tiranga Yatra through Connaught Place with around 5,000 students from its Atal Adarsh and Navyug schools as part of the 'Har Ghar Tiranga' campaign next week, officials said.

DELHI AIRPORT CONNECTS 90 DOMESTIC DESTINATIONS, SAYS DIAL

NEW DELHI: Delhi airport operator DIAL on Tuesday said the airport offers flights to 90 domestic destinations, with the launch of services to Daman. Alliance Air operates services between Delhi and Daman. The airport has more than 1,050 daily domestic flight movements and over 5 million domestic passengers every month, according to a release.

FINAL ELECTORAL ROLLS TO BE PUBLISHED ON OCT 27

SIR: BLO house visits extended till August 17

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Election Commission of India (ECI) on Tuesday revised the SIR (Special Intensive Revision) dates in Delhi, with the door-to-door verification exercise by booth-level officers (BLOs) extended till August 17 and the publication of electoral rolls rescheduled for October 27.

This is the second extension for the revision of voter rolls in the Capital this month. The door-to-door verification exercise currently underway was earlier scheduled to conclude on August 8.

According to the poll panel, the draft electoral rolls will be now published on August 24, instead of August 17.

After publication of the draft rolls, the voters will be able to

file their claims and objections from August 24 to September 23, as per the revised schedule. Earlier, the claims and objection filing period was August 17 to September 16.

The claims and objections filed by the voters will have to be disposed of by the poll officials between August 24 and October 22. The final voter lists will be published on October 27, instead of October 19 as scheduled earlier.

Currently, the BLOs in Delhi have distributed enumeration forms to almost all the 1.45 crore voters in the city while over 62 per cent of the filled up forms were digitised.

Before this extension, the last date for the door-to-door verification exercise by BLOs was August 8.

The Delhi Chief Electoral

Officer (CEO) in a press statement, said that the fresh extension was aimed at giving some more time to voters for submitting their filled up enumeration forms.

The process of digitisation of enumeration forms submitted by the voters has been a little slower in Delhi due to multiple reasons. The Delhi CEO office has requested the voters who have still not submitted their enumeration forms to do so at the earliest.

The BLOs have claimed that many voters have yet to return the forms provided to them. Errors in details provided by the voters, technical issues, difficulty in finding voter details previously recorded, etc, have also been cited as factors delaying the digitisation of enumeration forms.

CM cancels Dwarka medical store licence

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

NEW DELHI: Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said on Tuesday that the license of a vendor running a medical store at a government hospital in Dwarka had been cancelled over the staff's refusal to provide medicines to the public.

The action comes a day after the issue was flagged to the chief minister.

Emphasising that public service is non-negotiable, Gupta asserted that there will be zero tolerance for negligence, indifference, or abuse of authority in Delhi. Every public-facing institution exists to serve the people, not to inconvenience them, she stated.

"The licence of the concerned medical store stands cancelled with immediate effect. Those who deny citizens their rightful services, defy lawful directions or display arrogance towards the public will face the



full force of the law," she said in a post on X.

On Monday, Gupta had promised to take strict action against the vendor operating the Jan Aushadhi Kendra at the government hospital in Dwarka for refusing to supply medicines.

In her post, she shared a video showing a person complaining about the staff at the medical store who were denying medicines to patients and their attendants.

Gupta condemned such behaviour in public services as completely unacceptable, and promised to take strict action by cancelling the vendor's license.

Dengue, malaria, chikungunya cases down this year: MCD

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi has witnessed a decline in dengue, malaria and chikungunya cases compared to last year, with no deaths reported from the three diseases so far in 2026, even as the city recorded nine fresh dengue cases and four malaria cases in the week ending August 1, according to the latest MCD report.

As of August 1, Delhi has recorded 221 dengue cases, down from 291 cases reported during the corresponding period last year. Malaria cases have seen a drop, with 66 cases registered so far this year compared to 135 cases in the same timeframe in 2025. Chikungunya cases stand at 14, lower than the 20 cases recorded during this period last year.

According to the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) weekly report, no fatalities have been attributed to any of the three vector-borne illnesses so far in 2026. For the week ending August 1, the capital logged nine fresh dengue cases, four new malaria cases, and zero Chikungunya cases.

A detailed break-up of the local data shows that within the MCD zones, west Delhi has recorded the highest number of dengue cases this season at 37, followed by central Delhi 29 and Civil Lines and Shahdara North 21 cases each. For malaria, west Delhi also reported the highest cumulative tally at 17 cases, followed by south Delhi with 11 cases.

CENTRE TELLS SUPREME COURT

NEET-PG cut-off: ‘Panel formed for internal audit of admission system’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Centre on Tuesday told the Supreme Court that it has constituted a high-powered committee headed by the director general of health services (DGHS) to formulate a mechanism for conducting a comprehensive audit of the existing system of admission through the NEET-PG examination.

A bench of Justices P S Nar-

asimha and Alok Aradhe was hearing a batch of petitions challenging the reduction in the percentile cut-off for NEET-PG 2025.

The bench was told by Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati that as per oral direction, the government has constituted a panel through a notification dated July 23 in which there are 12 members including the DGHS, who will be the chairman.

She submitted that the term of reference of the committee will be to formulate the mechanism for internal audit of the existing system of admissions through NEET, to identify the lacunae in the existing system, and to find implementable and practical solutions for the same.

The bench recorded the submission of Bhati and gave eight weeks to the panel to file its report. “We will actively discuss the issue

once the report comes in,” the bench said.

It said the panel may co-opt members from National Commission for Indian System of Medicine (NCISM) and National Commission for Homeopathy (NCH). Earlier, the top court said it would examine whether the sharp reduction in the qualifying marks for NEET-PG 2025-26 affects the standard of postgraduate medical education.

The top court had said that although the Union was justified in stating that NEET-PG was not an entry into MBBS and that candidates are already doctors, the court would still like to consider the effect of reducing the cut-off.

Pleas have been filed in the apex court by social worker Harisharan Devgan, Dr Saurav Kumar, Dr Lakshya Mittal and Dr Akash Soni claiming that the cut-off reduction violates Articles

14 and 21.

Senior advocate Pinky Anand and advocate Satyam Singh Rajput appeared for Devgan in the matter.

The petitioners have challenged the January 13 notice issued by the National Board of Examination in Medical Sciences (NBEMS), by which the minimum qualifying percentile cut-off for counselling of the third round of NEET-PG 2025-2026

was reduced.

The director general of health services of the Union health ministry, in its affidavit filed in the matter, had said that the challenge by petitioners pertains to an academic and policy determination taken by competent statutory authorities under the National Medical Commission Act 2019 in public interest and within the domain of expert regulation.

“It is respectfully submitted

that the reduction of qualifying percentile for NEET-PG is not unprecedented. Since the inception of NEET-PG in 2017 percentile reductions have been affected in appropriate circumstances to prevent seat wastage. In the academic year 2023 as well, the qualifying percentile was reduced to zero across categories. The present decision is thus consistent with the established policy and administrative practice,” it had said.

From Page 1

SC tightens

It also directed authorities to create public awareness about both modules so that victims know where to seek assistance after falling prey to cyber fraud.

The Registrars General of all High Courts were asked to inform courts and other adjudicating authorities about these mechanisms to help them deal with matters involving freezing of bank accounts connected to cyber fraud. The court said an aggrieved person should ordinarily be encouraged to first use these grievance mechanisms, while making it clear that doing so would not affect any constitutional, statutory or other legal remedies available under law.

Seeking greater accountability, the Supreme Court asked authorities to submit in their next status reports state-wise and bank-wise data on grievances registered and disposed of, along with details of restoration orders issued and the amounts returned to victims. The court said such information would help assess how effectively complaints are being handled across different states and banking institutions.

The bench also directed authorities to ensure the expeditious disposal of cases related to freezing bank accounts during cyber fraud investigations so that victims do not face unnecessary delays.

On institutional preparedness, the court noted that only 18 states have so far established State Cyber Crime Coordination Centres. It directed the remaining states to notify and operationalise these centres within four weeks and also take steps, in consultation with the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C), to adopt the e-Zero FIR mechanism. The I4C was asked to provide all necessary assistance and follow-up support for implementation.

The court further directed the Centre's Inter-Departmental Committee to issue advisories and instructions to states, UTs, ministries and government departments to conduct awareness programmes on cybercrime, including digital arrest scams, and publicise the grievance redressal and money restoration modules.

The committee was also asked to consult banks and financial intermediaries on technological measures to prevent digital arrest scams, improve recovery of money lost by victims, facilitate investigations and ensure compliance with legal obligations. In addition, it was directed to examine the proposal for a shared liability and victim compensation framework.

The State Legal Services Authorities were instructed to undertake awareness campaigns on preventing digital arrest scams, cyber security and the assistance available for recovery of defrauded money.

Referring to its earlier directions in the matter, the bench said they were aimed at ensuring a coordinated response by various ministries on issues including CBI investigations, mule accounts, misuse of SIM cards and SIM boxes, cooperation by intermediaries, grievance redressal, restoration of defrauded funds and institutional coordination.

The latest directions come a week after the Supreme Court suggested that the Centre consider formally defining “digital arrest” as a separate offence under criminal law with stringent punishment, as part of efforts to strengthen the legal framework against the growing menace of online financial fraud.

India calls PoK

their crackdown on protesters. “The Pakistani establishment has answered public discontent with bullets, blackouts, intimidation and repression, and now seeks to manufacture legitimacy through a hollow electoral exercise,” Jaiswal said. He added that Pakistan “must

be held accountable, and the world should see through the flimsy veneer of Pakistan's hypocritical lecturing on human rights.”

PoK has witnessed widespread protests since last month over rising living costs, alleged administrative neglect, political discrimination and reported atrocities against minorities. The demonstrations have been led by the Joint Awami Action Committee (JAAC), including a long march from Rawalakote to Muzaffarabad late last month.

According to reports, Pakistani security forces used lethal force against JAAC protesters during the march. The crackdown reportedly left 40 civilians dead and more than 33 protesters injured. The JAAC has appealed to the United Nations Human Rights Council and international human rights organisations for an immediate and independent investigation into what it termed “unlawful killings”.

Jaiswal also urged Pakistan to act against terrorism originating from its territory.

“We call upon countries to take strong action against cross-border terrorism and those promoting it. We call upon Pakistan to take strong action against cross-border terrorism and dismantle the terrorist infrastructure operating from its soil,” he said.

On the Indus Waters Treaty (IWT), Jaiswal reiterated that the agreement would remain suspended until Pakistan permanently ends its support for cross-border terrorism.

“The treaty is in abeyance and will remain so until Pakistan irrevocably and credibly abjures its support for cross-border terrorism,” he said.

India had placed the IWT in abeyance after the Pahalgam terror attack in April last year, in which 26 civilians were killed, as part of a series of diplomatic and economic measures against Pakistan.

Sheikh Hasina

Dhaka on Monday sought a clarification from the Indian side on Hasina's plan, with Prime Minister Tarique Rahman's foreign affairs adviser Humaiun Kobir saying the public interaction from Indian soil could undermine the positive momentum witnessed in the bilateral ties in the recent months.

When asked during the weekly media briefing, Ministry of External Affairs spokesman Randhir Jaiswal stated that there was absolutely no link between the Indian government and the programme. “The dialogue you are talking about is being organised by a private media organisation. The government has absolutely no role to play in it, nor does it have any opinion regarding what opinions may be expressed at the forum.”

The issue was raised in a meeting between Bangladesh's Adviser on Foreign Affairs, Humayun Kabir, and India's newly appointed High Commissioner to Bangladesh, Dinesh Trivedi, at the prime minister's office in Tejgaon.

Bangladesh's State Minister for Foreign Affairs Shama Obaed Islam said on Monday that Hasina's public political activities from Indian territory could have a negative impact on relations between the two countries.

The former prime minister is set to address the virtual press conference at the Foreign Correspondents' Club. Though Hasina had given a series of e-mail interviews over the past few months, it will be her first media interaction.

The Awami League leader has already announced her plan to return to Dhaka by the end of this year, and she is likely to elaborate on that during the media interaction.

Hasina's son Sajeeb Wazed Joy and a number of other Awami League leaders, including Mohibul Hasan Chowdhury Nowfel and Shakib Al Hasan, are likely to speak at the conference. Hasina, 78, has been living in India since fleeing Dhaka on August 5, 2024.

Last November, Hasina was sentenced to death in absentia by a special tribunal in Dhaka for alleged “crimes against humanity”

over her government's brutal crackdown on student-led protests in 2024. Since the verdict, Dhaka has been urging New Delhi to extradite her to face the law.

The relations between India and Bangladesh witnessed a major downturn after the interim government headed by Muhammad Yunus came to power following the collapse of the Hasina government.

The two sides initiated efforts to stabilise the relations after Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla, accompanied by Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri, represented India at the inauguration of Rahman as the prime minister in Dhaka on February 17.

In April, Bangladesh Foreign Minister Khalilur Rahman visited India as part of efforts to repair the strained bilateral ties following more than 18 months of heightened diplomatic tension.

It was the first high-level visit to India by a senior member of the new Bangladesh Nationalist Party government.

SC proposes

The bench expressed concern that around 56 per cent of vehicles on Indian roads remain uninsured, citing the Standing Committee on Finance Report 2024-25. In absolute numbers, it said 16.54 crore of the country's 30.48 crore vehicles do not have insurance.

Referring to its 2018 order requiring three years of third-party insurance for new cars and five years for new two-wheelers at the time of purchase, the court observed that compliance remained poor. It directed that the mandatory period now be increased to four years for new cars and six years for new two-wheelers, asking IRDAI to issue the necessary directions immediately.

The bench said compulsory insurance exists not only to compensate road accident victims but also to spare them prolonged legal battles. It observed that uninsured vehicles often leave victims and their families without timely compensation, especially in cases involving death or permanent disability.

The court also directed IRDAI and MoRTH to introduce ANPR cameras on selected corridors and integrate them with the Insurance Information Bureau and the VAHAN database for automatic issuance of e-challans to uninsured vehicles.

Observing that there is no uniform mechanism for police to verify insurance status on the ground, the bench ordered that state police be equipped with handheld devices or mobile applications linked to the Insurance Information Bureau and VAHAN portal for real-time verification and enforcement.

Separately, taking note of frequent road accidents on national highways and congestion at toll plazas, the court directed the Centre to launch pilot projects on selected highway corridors replacing physical toll stoppages with automatic vehicle detection systems.

The directions came while hearing a motor accident compensation matter, with the court noting that despite an existing legal framework mandating third-party insurance, poor compliance continues to leave accident victims and their families struggling to secure compensation. It also asked IRDAI to provide private vehicle owners with multiple policy options, including a basic statutory cover as well as add-on, personal accident and own-damage policies.

Missing three

BJP,” saying he could not “compromise on Muslim interests”.

Adding to the intrigue, Trinamool leaders Saugata Roy and Kunal Ghosh claimed on Tuesday that some of the rebels had opened channels of communication with the party and were exploring a possible return, raising fresh questions over the stability of the breakaway TMC groups.

West Bengal Chief Minister and senior BJP leader Suwendu

Adhikari added a fresh twist to the unfolding political drama by hosting the rebel MPs for an hour-long lunch at Banga Bhawan in New Delhi on Tuesday, a meeting widely seen as signalling growing proximity between the BJP and the break-away group.

A delicious meal was served to the MPs, featuring dishes such as Hilsa fish and prawns, alongside “Chhola Dal” (Bengal gram lentils).

According to sources, Union Environment minister Bhupendra Yadav and BJP MP Nishikant Dubey — who apparently played pivotal roles in the Trinamool rebellion — were also present at the lunch.

After the meet with Suwendu, the attendee MPs, however, claimed that discussions centred on development projects for their respective constituencies. Addressing reporters after the meeting, NCPI MP Satabdi Roy dismissed the speculations that NCPI MPs would formally join the BJP.

“We spoke only about the development of our constituencies. The Chief Minister asked us to submit proposals. We will meet him again at Nabanna and place our proposals,” Roy said.

After the meeting, Adhikari left Banga Bhawan. BJP's Rajya Sabha MP Sukhendu Sekhar Roy, who was also present, described the visit as a “courtesy call”.

Two other BJP Rajya Sabha MPs, Susmita Deb and Prakash-chik Barik, who had resigned from TMC before joining BJP, also took part in the meeting.

Sources said actor-turned-politician Dev skipped the meeting because of a pre-scheduled film shoot.

The meeting came hours after the NDA parliamentary meeting at the Parliament Library building, where NCPI parliamentary party leader Sudip Bandopadhyay asserted that “everyone in NCPI is united”.

Bandopadhyay, the leader of the 20 MPs, had separately met the Prime Minister on Monday amid speculation that they might join the BJP.

Meanwhile, the Mamata Banerjee camp sharpened its attack on the rebels, accusing them of betraying the mandate they had secured on the Trinamool Congress symbol and anti-BJP votes. The leaders alleged that the MPs, elected on the back of the party's support, were now working to further the BJP's political interests.

“The BJP is protecting them. Otherwise, they would have lost their Lok Sabha membership because they won the polls on TMC tickets,” said TMC leader Kunal Ghosh.

The Belaghata MLA also claimed at least 30 of the 60 TMC legislators who joined the rebel Ritabrata Banerjee-led faction were in touch with Mamata Banerjee and other leaders in their group.

Ritabrata Banerjee, however, dismissed Ghosh's claim, saying: “They should be more concerned about the rest of the MPs who are ready to leave them.”

AI Phuket-Delhi flight

sustained minor injuries after the aircraft experienced a sudden loss of approximately 300 feet in altitude.

Air India, however, said the aircraft encountered a brief turbulence-related event during the cruise phase that caused a momentary change in altitude. The airline said the flight landed safely in Delhi and all passengers and crew disembarked without difficulty.

“There has been no report of serious injuries. A small number of passengers and crew members with minor injuries requiring medical assessment have been taken to a medical facility at the airport for precautionary examination and care,” the airline said in a statement issued around 1.30 pm.

The carrier said it was extending all necessary assistance to those affected and was fully cooperating with the authorities investigating the incident.

As of now, the plane that made

the emergency landing has been shifted to the hanger, and the black boxes including the Flight Data Recorder (FDR) and Cockpit Voice Recorder (CVR) were removed for further analysis.

The DGCA has started with the probe to identify the reason behind the altitude dip and the passengers' safety is the top priority, said the Ministry of Civil Aviation. Besides, the civil aviation ministry is closely monitoring the situation in coordination with the DGCA.

While pilots routinely alert passengers about possible turbulence, particularly during adverse weather, incidents causing injuries to passengers and crew are uncommon.

In May 2024, severe turbulence on a Singapore Airlines flight from London to Singapore left one passenger dead from a suspected heart attack and injured many others. A similar incident involving a SpiceJet flight from Mumbai to Durgapur in May 2022 resulted in one passenger's death and several injuries.

DMK’s

Udhayanidhi

Party workers welcomed him outside the police station with garlands and firecrackers, while senior DMK leaders, including P K Sekarbaru, and a team of lawyers accompanied him.

Speaking before being taken away, Udhayanidhi denied the allegation and said, “Did I mention anyone's name except the CMs? Then why do you think this is happening? Let the court decide.”

After his release, he rejected the allegation that he had made a double-meaning remark, saying his speech carried only a “single meaning” and was intended to demand Cauvery water for Tamil Nadu. He accused the government of distorting his speech through a “cut, copy, paste” method and claimed he had been taken away “like a terrorist”.

The case stems from a protest meeting on the Cauvery issue held in Thanjavur on August 3. Police booked Udhayanidhi under nine sections of law, including provisions related to the use of obscene words, insulting the modesty of a woman, promoting enmity, provoking riots, criminal intimidation and the Tamil Nadu Prohibition of Harassment of Women Act.

The complaint was filed by TVK's Thanjavur Central District Women's Wing organiser S Bairavi, who alleged that when the crowd shouted “Trisha, Trisha” during the speech, Udhayanidhi responded with an obscene double-meaning remark. The complaint also accused him and DMK IT wing office-bearers of circulating a 2-minute, 39-second video of the incident on X, causing mental distress to the actor and women in general and creating public unrest.

TVK national spokesperson Pazha Selvakumar also approached the National Commission for Women, urging it to seek an explanation from Udhayanidhi and demand an unconditional public apology.

As police reached his residence, Udhayanidhi moved the Madras High Court seeking anticipatory bail. During the hearing, police informed the court that they did not intend to seek his remand and would release him on station bail after questioning.

DMK president and former Chief Minister M K Stalin condemned the arrest, calling the TVK government “fascist” and alleging that his son was taken to Thanjavur under non-bailable charges to prevent him from attending the Assembly Budget session. He questioned why Udhayanidhi had to be transported to Thanjavur if police only intended to question him and warned that “arrogance will lead to destruction.”

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K Palanisami criticised the government for arresting the Leader of the Opposition a day before the Budget session, while also condemning Udhayanidhi for his alleged offensive remark. DMDK chief Premalatha Vijayakant and AIADMK Deputy General Secretary K P Munusamy

also questioned the government's action.

Defending the police move, Minister Aadhav Arjuna said at a party meeting that strict action would be taken against anyone making derogatory comments about women. Tamil Nadu Electricity Minister R Nirmal Kumar said the mindset reflected in Udhayanidhi's alleged remark was “completely unacceptable” for anyone holding public office.

While TVK workers staged demonstrations demanding action against Udhayanidhi, DMK cadres held statewide protests condemning his arrest.

Monsoon

Wayanad, Kannur and Kasaragod, while four districts remained under an orange alert and two under a yellow alert. The weather office has also issued an orange alert for nine districts on Wednesday.

Floodwaters continued to affect riverside and low-lying areas in Alappuzha, Pathanamthitta, Kottayam and Kozhikode, forcing families into relief camps where many reported losing household belongings, official documents and children's school books.

Tourism Minister P C Vishnunadh said special adalats would be organised to restore lost documents and students would receive replacement textbooks and study materials. He also said Rs 25,000 had been sanctioned for cleaning work in every ward, with volunteer groups joining restoration efforts. Chief Minister V D Saheesan announced that financial assistance for those who lost homes and livelihoods would be released without delay.

Authorities said water levels in the Muvattupuzha and Thodupuzha rivers remained above warning levels on Tuesday morning but were gradually receding. Several hydropower reservoirs, including Moozhiyar, Kallarkutty, Erattayar, Lower Periyar, Poringalkuthu and Kuttiyadi, have reached the red alert level, prompting close monitoring.

In Jharkhand, 14 people died and four others were injured after lightning struck different parts of Girdih, Dumka and Latehar districts.

Nine deaths were reported from Girdih, including five young people who were struck while sitting together after playing in the Deori police station area. Four of the victims there were aged between 18 and 20 years. Three people died in Dumka and two in Latehar in separate incidents.

Assam's flood situation showed further improvement, though two more deaths reported from Sivasagar and Golaghat raised this year's flood toll to 89. More than 1.22 lakh people remain affected across five districts, with Sivasagar accounting for nearly 60,000 affected residents.

The Assam State Disaster Management Authority said 365 villages remain inundated and 15,342.92 hectares of cropland have been damaged. Around 17,857 people are staying in 55 relief camps and distribution centres. Floodwaters have also affected 26,575 domestic animals and poultry, while the Dhansiri river at Numaligarh continues to flow above the danger mark.

In Odisha, floodwaters were slowly receding in several districts, but many villages in Jajpur, Bhadrak and Jagatsinghpur remained cut off as submerged roads prevented residents from returning home. The IMD has forecast another wet spell from August 5 to August 10, with heavy to very heavy rainfall expected in parts of the state.

Officials said the recent floods affected 8.64 lakh people across 22 districts, impacting 1,458 villages, damaging 3,567 houses and claiming six lives. Chief Secretary Anu Garg directed departments to speed up restoration of breached embankments and ensure adequate relief supplies, including fodder for livestock.

In Himachal Pradesh, torrential rain led to the closure of 153 roads, while 58 water supply schemes

and 191 electricity transformers remained disrupted. A yellow alert for heavy rain has been issued till August 10.

Police and Home Guard personnel rescued 25 members of nomadic Gujjar families trapped in the swollen Jalmusha river in Sirmaur district by forming a human chain with ropes.

In a separate incident in Sirmaur, two members of a family died and one woman was injured after their car plunged into a 300-foot-deep gorge during heavy rain. Police have registered a case and launched an investigation.

Heavy rainfall also continued across Coastal Karnataka, where Hakladi in Udupi district received 189 mm, the highest in the state during the 24-hour period ending Tuesday morning. The IMD warned of further heavy rainfall, strong winds and rough sea conditions, advising fishermen not to venture into the Arabian Sea.

Rain brought relief from humid weather in Punjab and Haryana, with Patiala recording 143 mm and Ambala 94.6 mm. In Rajasthan, Mandawar in Dausa district recorded 107 mm of rainfall. The IMD said another cyclonic circulation is likely to form over eastern Rajasthan between August 6 and 7, leading to increased rainfall through August 10.

In Gujarat, where severe flooding hit parts of the state last week, the health department said it had organised 6,868 medical camps, deployed over 18,000 surveillance teams and distributed more than 1.05 crore chlorine tablets and 10.29 lakh ORS packets to prevent disease outbreaks. More than 7.61 lakh people in 562 villages received preventive medicines against leptospirosis, while officials said no major public health emergency had been reported so far.

Meanwhile, the Maharashtra government approved an enhanced Rs 81.22 crore flood relief package for Palghar district and Vasai-Virar Municipal Corporation, substantially increasing compensation for losses suffered during the July rains. The revised package includes assistance for small businesses, daily wage earners and livelihood losses that were previously not covered under conventional relief norms.

Meteorologists said the southwest monsoon is likely to remain active over the next two weeks as atmospheric conditions become increasingly favourable for widespread rainfall across the country, with weather systems over the Bay of Bengal and the Indian Ocean expected to support another intense spell of monsoon activity.

Blue-strip labels

AMR (NAP-AMR) 2.0, under which surveillance systems tracking antimicrobial resistance and antimicrobial consumption have been strengthened across the human, animal, food and environment sectors. “The plan promotes antimicrobial stewardship programmes in healthcare settings and prioritises behaviour change communication and public awareness campaigns targeting all stakeholders to promote rational and judicious use of antimicrobials,” Jadhav said.

The minister said the Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) regulates the safety, efficacy and quality of medicines under the Drugs and Cosmetics Act, while State Licensing Authorities oversee the sale and distribution of drugs under the Drugs Rules, 1945.

Jadhav also reminded the House that antibiotics are classified under Schedule H and Schedule H1 of the Drugs and Cosmetics Rules and can be sold only against the prescription of a registered medical practitioner.

To strengthen enforcement, the Centre has advised all States and Union Territories to carry out regular prescription audits in public health facilities. The CDSCO has also issued notices and advisories directing strict compliance with regulatory provisions to prevent the misuse of antibiotics, the government said.



EDITORIAL

BEYOND THE DIGITAL TRAP

India's battle against cybercrime has reached a point where incremental responses are no longer enough. The Supreme Court's latest intervention on "digital arrest" scams reflects a sobering reality: fraudsters have evolved faster than institutions. Criminals posing as police officers, judges, CBI officials or telecom regulators have extracted thousands of crores from unsuspecting citizens by exploiting fear rather than technical sophistication. Victims are coerced into believing they are under investigation, isolated through continuous video calls and persuaded to transfer life savings into so-called "safe accounts". These scams have targeted pensioners, professionals, students and even senior government officials. The Court's directions, therefore, are not merely procedural reforms; they represent an attempt to create a coordinated national response to a crime that thrives on fragmented regulation. Asking the Reserve Bank of India to frame a standard operating procedure for banks, directing States to operationalise cyber coordination centres, and exploring a compensation framework are all steps that acknowledge cyber fraud as a systemic challenge rather than a series of isolated crimes.

The banking ecosystem lies at the heart of both the problem and the solution. Money stolen through digital arrest scams often passes through multiple mule accounts within minutes, making recovery extremely difficult. Banks have traditionally focused on protecting their own systems from hackers, but today's challenge is different. Customers are being manipulated into authorising transactions themselves. That makes speed the single most important weapon. Temporary debit holds, real-time alerts, standardised grievance mechanisms and rapid restoration of funds can dramatically reduce losses if implemented uniformly. The Supreme Court's insistence on a common SOP is therefore timely. Equally significant is the proposal to create a victim compensation framework based on shared liability. Such a system should not encourage negligence, but neither should it leave victims completely unprotected when sophisticated criminal networks exploit institutional loopholes. Financial institutions, regulators, telecom operators and technology platforms all derive benefits from India's expanding digital economy; they must also share responsibility for protecting its users.

Technology alone, however, cannot defeat deception. The success of digital arrest scams stems from psychology. Fraudsters exploit fear of arrest, legal ignorance and blind trust in authority. They rely on panic, secrecy and urgency to stop victims from seeking independent advice. This is why awareness campaigns cannot remain confined to occasional advertisements or social media posts. Cyber safety must become part of everyday civic education. Schools, colleges, workplaces, resident welfare associations and local bodies should routinely educate people that no investigating agency conducts arrests through video calls, demands confidential financial information or orders money transfers into "secure" accounts. Legal Services Authorities, as directed by the Court, can play a transformative role by taking cyber awareness beyond urban centres into villages and smaller towns where digital adoption is rising rapidly. Equally important is the proposal to examine restrictions on suspicious telecom activity. While any such measure must carefully balance privacy and convenience, policymakers cannot ignore the fact that telecom networks have become the primary delivery channel for organised cyber fraud.

The Supreme Court has done what constitutional courts often do at critical moments: it has nudged multiple institutions into coordinated action. The real test, however, begins now. Directives on paper must translate into interoperable databases, responsive banks, accountable telecom providers, trained police personnel and informed citizens. Delays in freezing fraudulent transactions or jurisdictional confusion between agencies can erase the benefits of even the best-designed policies. India's digital economy is expanding at extraordinary speed through UPI, online banking and e-governance, making trust its most valuable currency. Every successful digital arrest scam weakens that trust. The country's response, therefore, cannot be reactive or fragmented. It must be preventive, technology-driven and citizen-centric. The Court has provided the blueprint. It is now for governments, regulators, financial institutions and telecom operators to ensure that India's digital transformation remains a story of empowerment rather than exploitation.

BHARAT KI SOCH



ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS THE CHAIRPERSON, BHARAT KI SOCH

Dronacharya exemplified discipline and mastery, but his life also warns that silence before injustice carries lasting institutional consequences forever

Excellence Needs Dharma's Guidance

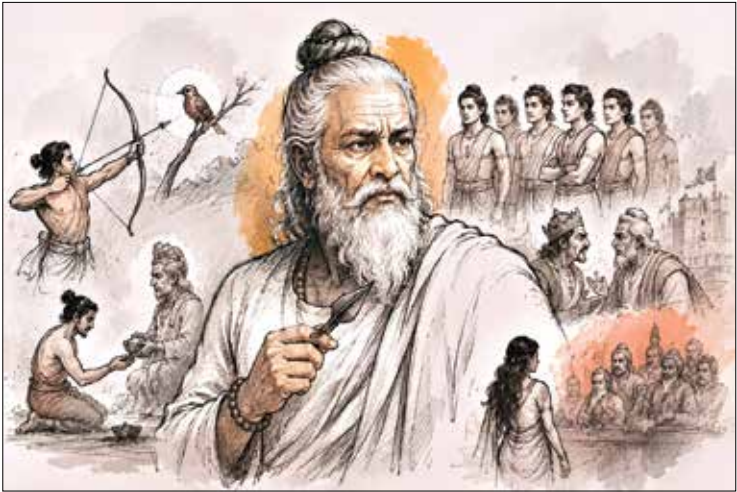
Dronacharya's life shows that knowledge, discipline and competence can build excellence, but only fairness, conscience and moral courage can make leadership truly enduring

The Mahabharata rarely gives us simple heroes or simple failures. It invites us to learn not only from greatness, but also from moral complexity. Few figures reveal this better than Dronacharya. He created extraordinary warriors, shaped disciplined minds and raised the standards of martial training in his age. His greatness lay in his mastery, rigour and ability to transform potential into excellence. Yet his life also asks a difficult question. Can excellence remain noble if it is not guided by fairness, character and dharma? Institutions endure when competence is strengthened by conscience, and when authority is governed by fairness.

Dronacharya was born to the sage Bharadwaja and became one of the greatest masters of warfare and weaponry. His early life was not one of privilege or comfort. He knew hardship, need and humiliation, yet he did not allow these circumstances to limit his pursuit of mastery. Through knowledge, preparation and disciplined effort, he earned the respect that later gave his authority credibility. Position may give a person power, but only competence makes that power worthy of trust.

As the teacher of the Kuru princes, Dronacharya brought rigour, structure and high expectations into their training. He did not treat learning casually. He understood that excellence is built through repetition, correction and focus. This is why he remains revered despite his flaws. He was not merely a teacher of weapons. He was a builder of capability. It must always be remembered that mastery is never accidental. It is created through discipline, repetition and sustained commitment.

Dronacharya's training of Arjuna is often remembered most strongly, but his contribution went far beyond one pupil. He trained students with very different temperaments and strengths. Bhishm's power, Yudhishtir's restraint, Arjuna's focus, Duryodhan's confidence and Ashwatthama's intensity all required different forms of guidance. A lesser teacher may have imposed uniformity, but Dronacharya understood that discipline must remain common while development must respond to the individual. Institutions become stronger when leaders recognise different kinds of ability and shape them through a shared standard of excellence. This is one reason he remains revered. He did not merely teach skill. He



His story challenges every leader to ask whether success achieved without fairness can truly deserve admiration or lasting legitimacy today

created a culture of preparation.

The famous episode in which Arjuna sees only the eye of the bird remains one of the finest lessons in concentration. Dronacharya was teaching more than archery. He was teaching clarity of purpose, the ability to remove distraction and the discipline to give one's full attention to what truly matters. In modern institutions, this lesson is equally relevant. Organisations often lose strength because they pursue too many priorities without discipline. When everything becomes important, nothing receives the focus required for excellence. Leadership therefore requires the courage to define what matters and the discipline to keep attention fixed upon it.

At the same time, Dronacharya's preference for Arjuna raises an ethical question. His desire to make Arjuna the greatest archer may have come from recognising Arjuna's extraordinary discipline and dedication. A teacher is right to encourage excellence where it is visible. But the danger begins when encouragement turns into partiality. Leadership must develop high performers in a way that expands excellence, not in a way that closes the door on others. Excellence should inspire competition, not become a reason to restrict opportunity.

The episode of Eklavya brings this tension into sharper focus. Eklavya, denied formal instruction, trained himself with remarkable devotion by accepting Dronacharya as his guru in spirit. When Dronacharya asked for his right

thumb as guru dakshina, Eklavya obeyed, but his ability was permanently affected. Some traditions interpret this episode as a reflection of how social hierarchy and royal structures could restrict access to knowledge and opportunity. Dronacharya lived within the social and political order of his age, and this context must be understood. Yet context does not remove the moral question, because fairness demands that merit should not be limited by status, proximity or privilege.

This is one of the strongest corporate lessons from his life. Every institution has people whose talent may remain unseen because they are outside established circles. They may not have access to mentors, visibility before decision-makers or the confidence to claim space. If leaders notice only those already close to power, institutions lose both talent and trust. A strong institution does not protect opportunity for a chosen few. It creates fair pathways through which many can rise.

Dronacharya's relationship with Drupada offers another important lesson. Drupada's rejection humiliated him deeply. When Dronacharya later became the teacher of the Kuru princes, he asked his students to capture Drupada as guru dakshina. The wound was personal, but the authority used to answer it was institutional. This is why personal grievance must never acquire institutional authority. Leaders may carry pain, insult or disappointment, but they must not allow these emotions to shape professional judgement or organisational action.

His loyalty to Hastinapur also reveals the complexity of dharma. Dronacharya owed his position, livelihood and recognition to the Kuru court. Loyalty, gratitude and duty were real forces in his life. But the Mahabharata repeatedly reminds us that dharma is not blind obedience. It requires the ability to honour one's duty to an institution while also remaining answerable to justice. Dharma requires loyalty to be balanced by conscience. When Draupadi was humiliated, Dronacharya's silence showed the danger of knowledge without moral courage.

This lesson is deeply relevant to leadership today. Senior figures shape culture not only by what they say, but by what they allow. If wrongdoing takes place and experienced leaders remain silent, silence begins to look like approval. Loyalty remains noble only when it is anchored in dharma. When it protects injustice, it loses its virtue and becomes complicity. Institutions need loyalty, but they need principled loyalty, not passive obedience.

During the Kurukshetra war, Dronacharya's strategic brilliance remained unquestioned. Yet his role within the Kaurava side shows how capability can become morally complicated when it serves a flawed cause. Under pressure, organisations too may justify questionable conduct in the name of results, loyalty or survival. The true test of culture comes when success and conscience come into conflict. The strongest leaders are those who refuse to cross ethical boundaries even when the pressure to do so is high.

Dronacharya's life should be remembered with balance and respect. His greatness lay in creating exceptional individuals, instilling discipline, demanding mastery and showing how focused training can transform potential into capability. His limitations remind us that even the finest knowledge must remain guided by dharma, fairness and self-awareness. That is what makes his story so enduring. It does not merely warn us against flawed judgement. It inspires every teacher, parent, mentor and leader to build people with rigour, guide them with fairness and use authority with conscience. The Mahabharata leaves modern leaders with a timeless reminder. Knowledge commands respect, discipline builds excellence, but only character, fairness and dharma create institutions that endure beyond their founders.

Views expressed are personal

THINKING AHEAD



RANJAN MUKHERJEE

THE WRITER IS A SENIOR IAF OFFICER WITH LONG EXPERIENCE OF CIVIL ADMINISTRATION IN GOVERNMENT IN VARIOUS DISCIPLINES/ MINISTRIES

GDP and technology may measure prosperity, but they cannot measure human happiness, ecological balance, or social trust—the qualities that ultimately determine whether civilisation is truly advancing

Price of Endless Progress

Economic growth and technological breakthroughs mean little if they erode humanity, ecological balance, social trust, and the planet's long-term future

One of the oldest and most important questions humanity keeps returning to is about progress. But progress towards what?

Probable answers that invariably arise point to over-dependency at the cost of humanity, the environment, ecological balance, and the overall well-being of mankind. Another equally important question is: What kind of future global system is this so-called progress actually building?

How We Measure Progress

The modern world often measures progress by metrics that are easy to count—GDP, stock prices, computing power, productivity, life expectancy, internet speeds, etc. There have been regular discussions on the GDP metric itself, questioning its wisdom. However, that is a separate debate.

By these measures, humanity has undoubtedly made extraordinary advances. Many diseases are now treatable, child mortality has fallen dramatically, billions have gained access to education and information, and technology has solved problems that would have been unimaginable a century ago.

Yet these measures do not capture everything that truly matters.

The Hidden Costs

Alongside these achievements, several worrying trends continue to raise legitimate concerns:

- Climate change and biodiversity loss.
- Pollution of air, water, and soil.
- Overconsumption of finite resources such as water and energy.
- Mental health challenges despite material abundance.
- Loneliness, polarisation, and the erosion of community life.
- A growing disconnect from natural ecosystems.

In that sense, technological or financial progress is not automatically human progress. They are merely tools. Whether they improve life depends entirely on how they are used and the goals they are meant to serve.

Is Life Becoming Increasingly Artificial?

A growing concern today is whether everything around us is becoming increasingly inorganic.

Not literally, of course, but many



Progress without wisdom is merely greater capability with greater consequences

aspects of modern life are becoming more artificial:

- More time spent indoors than outdoors.
- More interaction through screens than face-to-face conversations.
- More processed products than locally grown food.
- More built environments than natural surroundings.

This does not mean technology itself is the problem. A solar panel, a vaccine, or a clean water system is also "artificial," yet each significantly improves human well-being. The problem begins when technology replaces, rather than supports, our relationship with nature, community, and health.

The real question, therefore, is: What is the right balance?

Finding the Right Balance

A useful principle is that technology should help us live well within Earth's ecological limits—not help us exceed them faster by consuming natural resources at a menacing pace driven by greed.

There is a need to draw a line, and that time has already arrived.

That desired balance should include:

- Using renewable energy while protecting ecosystems.
- Designing products that can be repaired and recycled instead of discarded.
- Building cities with parks, trees, and walkable neighbourhoods.
- Measuring success not only by wealth but also by health, education, environ-

mental quality, affordable justice, and social trust.

- Encouraging innovation while constantly asking: What are its long-term consequences?

Redefining Progress

The next question that naturally arises is: What should mankind do?

Perhaps the challenge is not to stop progress but to redefine it.

Real progress should compel us to ask:

- Are future generations inheriting a healthier planet?
- Are people healthier in both body and mind?
- Are communities becoming more resilient?
- Is technology reducing suffering without creating greater harm?
- Are we preserving the diversity of life on Earth?

Financial systems should ideally reward activities that regenerate forests, soils, and oceans—not merely those that maximise short-term profits driven by greed. Scientific advances should always be accompanied by ethical reflection. Likewise, economic growth should be evaluated alongside ecological sustainability.

Learning From Nature

A broader understanding of how Mother Nature has sustained life for billions of years—through cycles rather than endless accumulation—should become essential knowledge, especially for schoolchildren. The objective should be to educate and prepare future generations to take corrective action.

Human economies, by contrast, often assume perpetual expansion.

One of the defining questions of this century is whether we can build economies that function more like ecosystems—where waste becomes a resource and growth is balanced by renewal. This idea resonates with the famous scientific principle that nothing is created and nothing is destroyed.

In that sense, the goal should not be to choose between technology and nature, but to make technology an ally of nature rather than its competitor.

A Timeless Reminder

The philosopher and environmental thinker E. F. Schumacher wrote that the real question is not simply how much we produce, but what we produce, how we produce it, and for what purpose.

That idea remains profoundly relevant today.

Perhaps real progress can be expressed simply:

A civilisation is truly progressing if it leaves its people wiser, healthier, and kinder, while leaving the Earth more capable of supporting life than it found it.

If technology, finance, and public policy move us towards that outcome, then it is genuine progress. If they move us away from it, then it is merely an advancement in capability without an advancement in wisdom.

The enduring challenge for humanity is to ensure that the two grow together.

The Need for Mid-Course Correction

James Gustave Speth observed that the greatest environmental problems confronting mankind are selfishness, greed, and apathy. To overcome these, he argued, humanity requires a profound spiritual and cultural transformation.

Sadly, that spiritual and cultural consciousness is missing from the vocabulary of many Western nations that are often considered progressive. Equally, India is not immune to blindly chasing the same model of so-called progress.

If we continue on the present path, the consequences are likely to be far more destructive.

Therefore, while there is still time, we must embrace a meaningful mid-course correction. That will require understanding, due diligence, and above all, the courage to swim against the current in order to reach the right destination.

Views expressed are personal

GLOBAL TEAM IN INDIA ON AUG 5-6

Meta to face govt questions on CSAM ‘lapses’ & content moderation issues

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Lapses in curbing ‘CSAM’ as well as wrongful action on prominent accounts are among a slew of concerns that the government will raise when it meets Meta’s global team, IT Secretary S Krishnan said on Tuesday, adding that a company at the forefront of technology should have been able to make its systems work as they are supposed to.

Meta’s global team will be in India on August 5 and 6, Krishnan said.

The upcoming meeting is significant as the government has summoned Meta’s top global executives after Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s recent Facebook post addressing Indian youth and promising stringent action against paper leaks was briefly restricted on the platform. Sources said top Meta executive Joel Kaplan is expected to be present at the

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The upcoming meeting is significant as the govt has summoned Meta’s top global executives after PM Modi’s recent Facebook was briefly restricted on the platform
- » Sources said top Meta executive Joel Kaplan is expected to be present at the meeting



» The company, which owns Facebook, had said that the content was removed “in error” and was restored on the platform

meeting.

While the US-headquartered social media giant had attributed the incident to a technical glitch and apologised, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) had found the explanation “inadequate”. The company, which owns Facebook, had said that the content was removed “in error” and was restored on the platform.

Meta has also been under regulatory scrutiny over the issue of Child Sexual Abuse Material (CSAM) in paid advertisements on Instagram, and the government, last month, slapped a notice on Meta over the issue.

“There are a range of issues...the CSAM issue was raised, so what measures have been taken regarding that, and synthetically generated infor-

mation ... to what extent that is being looked at. Then, for prominent personalities when they have verified accounts, if content has to be taken down, there have to be safeguards...all of these will be the issues (taken up),” Krishnan told reporters on the sidelines of the launch of an independent multimodal AI evaluation platform by AI4Bharat at IIT Madras and Josh Talks AI.

Meta, as one of the leading technology companies in the world, should have the technology to address such issues effectively, he said.

“We would like to understand from them (Meta) as to why some of these things have not been working the way they are supposed to work, and what are the challenges,” Krishnan added.

For platforms, there needs to be a clear understanding of India’s law, what compliance must look like, “and a clearer

understanding of how they intend to make sure compliance happens”, Krishnan said.

Government sources had earlier said that the issue is not just about technical aspects, but about “national security and public order”. Meta’s global team will be “categorically” asked to clarify on issues around algorithmic bias, how their algorithm operates and the company’s role in public order, they had said.

In the immediate aftermath of the issue, Meta had informed the IT Ministry that posts by the prime minister and select prominent accounts will be subject to additional oversight on the platform, with multiple levels of checks involving senior company officials. Meta wrote to the government outlining the specifics of enhanced and rigorous safeguards it implemented (on July 28) for content posted by PM Modi and other prominent accounts.

NEET: 6 candidates move SC over OMR sheet ‘discrepancies’

Top Court lists matter for hearing

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Six NEET-UG candidates approached the Supreme Court on Tuesday alleging discrepancies between the answers they had marked in their OMR sheets during the examination and the copies of those sheets made available by the National Testing Agency (NTA).

The plea was mentioned before Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, seeking an early hearing before the commencement of the counselling process. The lawyer told a bench comprising Chief Justice Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana that the case pertains to six students who secured more than 600 and 650 marks but claim that the OMR sheets uploaded by the NTA differ from the answers they had actually marked during the examination.

He also told the court that



They claimed that the OMR sheets uploaded by the NTA differ from the answers they had actually marked

the students had emailed the NTA and also visited its office, but received no response.

The bench then agreed to list the matter for hearing.

The NEET-UG 2026 exam, originally held on May 3, was cancelled following a paper leak and was re-conducted on June 21 by the NTA.

Amritsar: CISF foils currency smuggling bid



NARESH BISWANI

AMRITSAR: The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) foiled an attempt to smuggle foreign currency worth around Rs 30 lakh out of the country and handed over the passenger to the Directorate of Revenue Intelligence (DRI) for further legal action on Tuesday.

According to the CISF, the passenger had boarded a domestic flight from Sri Guru Ram Dass Jee International Airport here and was travelling to Bangkok via Delhi. During the security screening at the Security Hold Area (SHA), CISF personnel noticed suspicious behaviour and escorted the passenger to the Intensive Checking Room for a detailed examination. During the search, officials recovered USD 31,500 (approximately Rs 30 lakh) concealed in the passenger’s undergarment.

The passenger failed to produce valid documents authorising possession and carriage of the foreign currency. He was subsequently handed over to the DRI for initiating appropriate legal proceedings for allegedly violating provisions of the Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA).

The CISF said the successful interception reflected the force’s high level of vigilance and effective security screening at the airport.

The force reiterated its commitment to maintaining stringent security standards and said it would continue to strengthen surveillance and screening measures to prevent illegal activities at airports.

Invoke Akal Takht Sahib’s authority for Panthic unity: GSC to Jathedar

CHANDIGARH: The Global Sikh Council (GSC), representing Sikh organisations from nearly 30 countries, has urged Singh Sahib Giani Kuldeep Singh Gargaj, Jathedar of Sri Akal Takht Sahib, to assume direct leadership of the Sikh Panth, citing the current political and social challenges facing Punjab.

In a representation adopted by its Executive Committee, the GSC invoked the Sikh principles of Miri-Piri and Guru Granth-Guru Panth, saying Sri Akal Takht Sahib has historically guided the Panth during periods of crisis through its Jathedar.

The Council expressed concern over the fragmentation of Akali politics, noting that of the 11 registered Akali Dal factions, only the Shiromani Akali Dal (Badal) won seats in the 2022 Punjab Assembly elections. It said the divisions had weakened Sikh political representation at a time when Punjab faced issues such as law and order, drug abuse, river water disputes and rising debt.

The GSC appealed to the Jathedar to bring all Akali Dal factions, including those led by Sukhbir Singh Badal, Giani Harpreet Singh, Simranjit Singh Mann and Amritpal Singh, onto a common platform for the next Assembly elections through a consensus-based seat-sharing arrangement. It also suggested constituting a five-member presidium or appointing a consensus leader if required. MPOST

Hry: NGT orders action against miner for ‘illegal’ Aravalli road

NEW DELHI: The National Green Tribunal (NGT) has directed authorities in Haryana to take action against a private mining company for illegally carving out a road through the protected Aravalli forest area.

The green body was hearing a plea alleging that the project proponent M/s Maa Santoshi Khanij Udhog was granted Environmental Clearance in 2020 for carrying out mining operations at Mahendergarh’s Musnota village, but in violation of rules, it had made an illegal road to access its mines.

According to the plea, heavy vehicles transporting minerals were using the said road, damaging the Aravalli plantation area and violating

environmental norms.

A bench of NGT Chairperson Justice Prakash Shrivastava and expert member Afroz Ahmad noted that the tribunal had, earlier, formed a joint committee, which had submitted reports, saying that the temporary road was located in the Aravalli plantation and that the project proponent had not obtained the mandatory forest clearance under the Forest (Conservation) Act before constructing and using the carved-out road.

It cited a 2004 Supreme Court verdict which prohibited “any mining activity on the area under plantation under the Aravalli Project” and said, “the Aravalli hill range has to be

protected at any cost.”

The tribunal said, “The joint committee in its reports has rightly found that the “kacha rasta” (temporary road) for approaching mines of the Respondent 5 (M/s Maa Santoshi) passes through khasra numbers 258 and 270 of village Panchnota and these khasra numbers are part of Aravalli Plantation and forest land.”

In its order dated July 22, made available on Tuesday, the tribunal said that the temporary road did not exist earlier, but has been carved out and used by the project proponent. Besides, the entity never obtained forest clearance for constructing and using the temporary road. AGENCIES

Punjab CM links E20 rollout to US trade deal

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Tuesday accused the Centre of imposing E20 ethanol-blended petrol on vehicle owners without adequate scientific research or public consultation, alleging that the policy was driven by commitments under the India-US trade agreement rather than public interest.

Speaking in the Punjab Assembly while replying to a discussion on a resolution seeking suspension of the mandatory rollout of E20 fuel for vehicles not originally designed for it, Mann said the Centre had itself admitted in Parliament that E20 fuel reduces vehicle mileage, yet proceeded with its implementation without conducting proper studies or obtaining certification from engineering institutions or IITs



CM Bhagwant Mann speaks during a discussion in the Punjab Assembly

regarding its impact on vehicle engines.

Calling the move a matter of “grave concern”, Mann alleged that engines designed for E10 petrol had now been shifted to E20 despite widespread objections. He claimed the policy was placing an unnecessary financial burden on vehicle owners, many of whom purchase vehicles after years of savings or through EMIs.

Citing findings from a survey of over 45,000 vehicles, the Chief Minister claimed that 67 per cent of vehicle owners reported a significant drop in mileage, while 45 per cent experienced engine-related problems after using E20 fuel. Describing the policy as “open loot” of the common man’s hard-earned money, Mann said consumers were now being forced to spend additional

amounts on vehicle repairs.

Mann said more than two lakh signatures had been collected through a public petition, which AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal would submit to the Prime Minister. He also questioned the Centre over what he described as an abrupt advancement of the E20 rollout from its earlier target of 2030 to 2026. He alleged that the decision was linked to the India-US trade deal, claiming India would increase ethanol imports from nearly one billion litres to five billion litres over the next five years, amounting to nearly USD 20 billion.

Mann demanded that consumers be given the option to choose between pure petrol and E20 at fuel stations and called for a reduction in E20 prices. MPOST

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

UP Cabinet clears key reforms

LUCKNOW: The Uttar Pradesh Cabinet on Tuesday approved 21 proposals covering infrastructure, agriculture, social welfare, labour reforms and governance, with major decisions aimed at boosting connectivity, regional development and farmer welfare.

At a meeting chaired by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, the Cabinet cleared the construction of a 74.467-km six-lane access-controlled greenfield expressway connecting Jewar International Airport with the Ganga Expressway via Bulandshahr. Designed for future expansion to eight lanes, the project is expected to strengthen connectivity across western Uttar Pradesh and integrate with the state’s

Jewar-Ganga Eway link gets approval

expressway network.

The Cabinet also approved the formation of the Prayagraj-Chitrakoot Regional Development Authority to promote planned urbanisation and infrastructure development. It further cleared the transfer of Public Works Department-acquired land at seven locations to the Housing and Urban Planning Department for developing multi-purpose hubs. To promote innovation, the government approved the establishment of state-of-the-art U-Hubs in Lucknow and Noida. It also approved the creation of the Uttar Pradesh Nomadic Development Board for the socio-economic uplift-

ment of denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic communities, besides amending operational guidelines for the Vishwakarma Shram Samman Yojana 2.0 to strengthen support for traditional artisans.

In a major relief for farmers, the Cabinet approved implementation of the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana and the Restructured Weather-Based Crop Insurance Scheme for the 2026-27 financial year, covering both Kharif 2026 and Rabi 2026-27 seasons.

The Cabinet also approved amendments to the Uttar Pradesh Madrasa Education Board Act, 2004, notified the Wage Code Rules, 2026, and cleared amendments to service rules relating to the State Property and Geology and Mining departments.

SC told Asaram doesn’t require hospitalisation

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court was on Tuesday informed that experts from AIIMS have suggested that self-styled godman Asaram does not require hospitalisation for treatment but needs round-the-clock medical assistance.

A bench of Justices M M Sundresh and P B Varale was apprised of the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) report while hearing Asaram’s plea seeking an interim bail on health grounds.

“The report (of AIIMS) says there is no need for any hospitalisation,” one of the lawyers appearing for the Rajasthan government said, adding, “He (Asaram) is getting all the medical facilities”.

The bench posted the matter for hearing on August 6.

On July 21, the apex court had asked AIIMS to constitute a medical board to assess Asaram’s condition.

The Rajasthan High Court on May 27 upheld the conviction and life sentence awarded to Asaram in a case of rape of a minor in 2013.

On June 30, the apex court sought response from the Rajasthan government on Asaram’s plea challenging the HC order.



FILE PIC

Bail plea to be heard on Aug 6

The HC had upheld Asaram’s conviction in the case, but acquitted him of charges related to alleged gangrape and penetrative sexual assault on a child under the erstwhile Indian Penal Code and the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act. However, the HC upheld his conviction under IPC Section 376(2)(F) pertaining to rape of the minor, thereby retaining the sentence of life imprisonment awarded by the trial court. The HC had also upheld convictions under several other provisions, including Sections 342 (wrongful confinement), 370(4) (trafficking), 506 (criminal intimidation), 509 (insulting the modesty of a woman), 354(A) (sexual harassment) of the IPC, along with Sections 7/8 of the POCSO Act and Section 23 of the Juvenile Justice Act. AGENCIES

Clouded Leopard Day: India launches conservation action plan for species

‘Clouded leopards persist in small, isolated populations across N-E’

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India has launched the Clouded Leopard Conservation Action Plan (CAP) to reaffirm its commitment to the conservation of one of Asia’s most elusive wild cats, Environment Ministry officials said on Tuesday.

The announcement was made to mark the International Clouded Leopard Day, observed on August 4 every year.

The action plan provides a comprehensive framework for securing habitats, restoring forest connectivity, strengthening scientific monitoring and empowering local communities for conservation of the species.

Clouded leopard is among the most evolutionarily distinct and among the least studied felids in Asia, occupying a unique ecological niche as an arboreal predator in the forests of Northeast India and the Eastern Himalaya, according to a 2026 technical report of CAP for clouded leopard.

KEY POINTS

- » The announcement was made to mark the International Clouded Leopard Day, observed on August 4 every year
- » The action plan provides a comprehensive framework for securing habitats, restoring forest connectivity, strengthening scientific monitoring and empowering



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

local communities for conservation of the species

- » Clouded leopard is among the most evolutionarily distinct and among the least studied felids in Asia

It added that historically, the species was reported across Northeast’s forested hills and described as relatively common during the 19th century, but widespread deforestation and hunting through the 20th century caused sharp declines.

By the late 1900s, the clouded leopard was feared to be extirpated from many parts of its Indian range.

“Today, clouded leopard

ards persist in small, isolated populations across Assam, Arunachal Pradesh, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Mizoram, Manipur, Tripura and northern parts of West Bengal and Bihar... However, there is still no reliable estimate of the species’ total population in India,” said the report.

It highlighted that the species has a presence across multiple protected areas in the northeastern states, but conser-

vation attention outside these areas remains limited.

In India, the clouded leopard is listed under Schedule I of the Wild Life (Protection) Act (WPA), 1972, providing it absolute protection from hunting, trade and possession.

A key component of the CAP of the clouded leopard is the identification of 14 priority conservation landscapes across the Northeast.

It also provides for standardised scientific monitoring through camera traps, occupancy surveys, genetics and environmental DNA, enabling improved understanding of the species and its habitat requirements.

“Recognising the critical role of local communities in wildlife conservation, the action plan promotes community-based conservation and sustainable livelihood support. It also encourages transboundary cooperation with neighbouring range countries for coordinated conservation of the species across its range,” said the official.

Nation Briefs

CHARIOT WHEELS OF PURI RATH YATRA TO BE INSTALLED AT RASHTRAPATI BHAVAN

BHUBANESWAR: Wheels of the three chariots used in Puri’s annual Rath Yatra will be installed at Rashtrapati Bhavan, an official said on Tuesday. Shree Jagannath Temple Administration (SJTA) chief administrator Arabinda Padhee said he met President Droupadi Murmu at Lok Bhavan in Bhubaneswar and placed the proposal. “The President agreed to install the three wheels...,” he said in a statement. The wheels of Lord Jagannath’s ‘Nandighosh’, Lord Balabhadra’s ‘Taladh-waja’, and Goddess Subhadra’s ‘Darpadalan’ chariots will be installed at Rashtrapati Bhavan as a symbol of Odisha’s cultural and spiritual heritage, officials said.

GUWAHATI STATION GETS ‘GOLUKBUK’ DIGITAL TRAVEL ASSISTANCE KIOSKS: NFR

MALIGAON: Northeast Frontier Railway (NFR) on Tuesday launched the GoLuk-Buk Digital Travel Assistance Kiosk Network at Guwahati Railway Station under the New Innovative Non-Fare Revenue Ideas Scheme. The facility was inaugurated by NFR General Manager Chetan Kumar Shrivastava. The interactive kiosks enable passengers to compare and book hotels, cabs, food delivery, sleeping pods and other travel services through a single digital platform.



GOVERNMENT SAYS THE LAW WILL IMPROVE ACCURACY AND SERVICE DELIVERY

Parl passes Registration of Births and Deaths Bill amid Oppn protests

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Parliament on Tuesday passed a Bill that seeks to tighten regulations for delayed registration of births and deaths and makes it mandatory to get approval from a judicial magistrate (first class) for cases reported more than two years after the event.

"The Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Bill, 2026" was approved by the Rajya Sabha by a voice vote amid continuous sloganeering by Opposition members, who repeatedly demanded the presence of Union Home Minister Amit Shah in the House. The opposition members also raised slogans on the alleged theft of donations at Ram Temple in Ayodhya.

The Lok Sabha has already passed the Bill on Friday amid din.

The Bill seeks to amend provisions of the Registration



Nityanand Rai speaks in the Rajya Sabha during the Monsoon session of Parliament

of Births and Deaths Act, 1969 to tighten the existing norms, mandating an order from a judicial magistrate (first class) for birth and death registrations made more than two years after the event.

Under the existing law, registrations delayed by more than one year require an order from a district magistrate, sub-divisional magistrate, or an authorised executive magistrate, and the provision will continue to

apply for delays of up to two years under the amended law.

Replying to the debate amid continued slogan-shouting by Opposition members, Minister of State for Home Nityanand Rai said the Modi government was committed to ensuring that every child born in the country was registered and that every death was recorded so that deceased persons did not continue as "ghost voters" benefiting parties pur-

Highlights

- » The Bill seeks to amend provisions of the Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969 to tighten the existing norms, mandating an order from a judicial magistrate (first class) for birth and death registrations made more than two years after the event
- » Under the existing law, registrations delayed by more than one year require an order from a district magistrate, sub-divisional magistrate, or an authorised executive magistrate, and the provision will continue to apply for delays of up to two years under the amended law

suing "appeasement politics".

"The government wants that every child born in the country should be registered and every death should also be registered," Rai said the opposition members need to understand the provisions of the bill.

"The country wants that anyone born in the country, it is important that he or she is registered. Anyone who has died, cannot continue to remain in the voter lists to benefit some

parties," he said.

Taking a swipe at the Congress, he said, in some states, there are governments who welcome such people to remain in voter lists. "This will not happen any more," he asserted.

"In 2014, the total number of births registered in the country was 86.6 per cent. In 2024, it rose to 99.1 per cent. For deaths, in 2014, 72.5 per cent deaths were registered, while now it is 99.4 per cent."

AAP's march against E20 halted; Kejriwal stages sit-in

"The party was carrying more than 2.30 lakh petitions"

NEW DELHI: AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal on Tuesday marched towards the Prime Minister's residence with over 2.30 lakh petitions against E20 petrol but was stopped by Delhi Police, prompting him and party leaders to stage a sit-in on Firoz Shah Road and call for an intensified agitation against the blended fuel policy.

The march, which began with around 100 people, including vehicle owners the party said were affected by E20 petrol, saw protesters carrying bundles of petitions on their heads and shouting slogans against the Centre's ethanol-blended fuel policy.

The protesters shouted slogans such as "Trump ki gulami band karo", "Ethanol kharidna band karo", and "Petrol chor kaha milenge, BJP ke daftar mein".

Kejriwal was joined by former Delhi deputy chief minister Manish Sisodia, Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Singh, AAP leader Jasmine Shah and other



Arvind Kejriwal, Sanjay Singh and Manish Sisodia during the protest

party leaders. Police stopped the march near 5, Firoz Shah Road, where the leaders sat on the road with the petitions, insisting that they be accepted.

Police later took custody of the petitions after informing the delegation that the prime minister would not meet them. Police sources said the protesters would not be allowed to proceed beyond 5, Firoz Shah Road. "No one will be allowed ahead of 5, Firoz Shah Road. We have deployed adequate security, including Delhi Police and paramilitary forces,

to maintain law and order," a police officer said.

Addressing supporters before the march, Kejriwal said the party was carrying more than 2.30 lakh petitions signed by people from across the country. "We are going to the Prime Minister's residence with over 2.30 lakh petitions signed by people from across the country. We want the government to listen to the concerns of crores of vehicle owners who are facing problems because of E20 petrol," he said.

India brought back 274 fugitives from 36 countries since 2019: Govt

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Centre on Tuesday said that it has brought back 274 fugitive criminals from 36 countries between 2019 and July 2026 as part of an aggressive mission-mode campaign of tracking down economic offenders, which has made extradition a national security imperative under Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah.

The government stated that the campaign has been able to secure national security, economic interests, law and order, and sovereignty by building a global network of intelligence and technology driven operations based on global outreach,

The issuance of Interpol Red Corner Notices has also increased

multi-agency coordination and diplomacy.

It said that fugitive criminals in recent years are increasingly threatening India's strategic interests, economic security, sovereignty, and territorial integrity, and noted that key laws such as the Fugitive Economic Offenders Act, 2018 and NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 and UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 have enhanced India's legal and operational capabilities to handle such cases.

The government said that new procedural provisions under the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), 2024 have empowered the courts to try in-absentia under Sections 355 and 356.

Further, the campaign has been able to facilitate faster adjudication and execution of judgment by establishing 'BHARATPOL' digital platform in January 2025 for real-time sharing of information with more than 1,400 state and central agencies and Interpol.

"The time taken to share information with global partners through this portal has come down significantly - from several months to just three to ten days," the government said.

Kharge demands Modi's reply on Ram Temple row

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge on Tuesday said Prime Minister Narendra Modi could not evade accountability over serious allegations relating to offerings, donations and land transactions linked to the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust, and demanded a parliamentary statement.

Speaking in the Rajya Sabha, Kharge alleged that the Trust, constituted by the Centre and formed by the Prime Minister, had come under scrutiny regarding valuable offerings, cash donations and land purchases connected to the Ayodhya Ram Temple. "The issue is directly linked to the faith of millions of devotees," he said.

Kharge noted that the Centre had transferred over 70 acres

LS proceedings adjourned for the day after passing Appropriation Bill

NEW DELHI: Lok Sabha proceedings were adjourned for the day on Tuesday after the passage of the Appropriation Bill, 2026 amid Opposition protest over alleged theft of donation at the Ram Temple and other issues. Soon after the House assembled at 2 pm after an earlier adjournment, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman introduced a Bill to replace an Ordinance which scrapped income tax with regard to foreign investment in government securities. Opposition members, who had given notices to speak against introduction of the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026, chose not to do so despite their names being called by the Chair.

of land to the Trust and that Modi had attended all major temple events from 'bhoomi puja' to 'Pran Pratishtha' ceremony. "Under these circumstances, the Prime Minister cannot avoid accountability," the Opposition leader said.

Questioning the impartiality of central investigative agencies, Kharge asked where the ED, CBI and Income Tax Department stood on the matter. "Those responsible for the plunder in the name of Lord Shri Ram should apologise to

the nation and stop misleading the public," he said.

Treasury Bench members interrupted his address with protests, preventing him from completing remarks.

Opposition MPs, including Congress general secretary Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, protested in Parliament House complex against the alleged theft of donations at the Ram temple and "police excesses" against student protesters.

Carrying placards against the government, MPs protested in front of the Makar Dwar of Parliament with slogans such as 'chhanda chor, gaddi chor' and 'Amit Shah jawaab do' raised.

The MPs also kept donation boxes at the spot to symbolise the alleged theft of donations at the Ram temple and lined up around them to raise slogans against the government.

UP channels nearly Rs 60K crore into roads, industry

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: With the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly election drawing closer, the Yogi Adityanath government has unveiled a Rs 59,019.54 crore supplementary budget that places infrastructure, industrial growth and rural connectivity ahead of fresh welfare giveaways, signalling that it intends to seek votes on its development record rather than announcing a slew of election-year freebies.

The supplementary budget, tabled in the state legislature on Tuesday, channels the largest share of additional spending into roads, villages, industrial infrastructure and the power sector. While it provides additional funds for running several existing welfare schemes, including those for women, children and persons with disabilities, it does not propose higher pensions for old-age, widow or destitute beneficiaries, nor does it announce any new flagship cash transfer programme or the much-speculated free scooty scheme for girls.

The biggest beneficiary is rural development. The government has earmarked an additional Rs 16,432.46 crore for village development programmes, making it the largest allocation in the supplementary budget. Another Rs 15,750.01 crore has been provided for roads and transport infrastructure, reflecting the government's strategy of strengthening rural connectivity and supporting economic activity beyond urban centres.

Among the key projects receiving fresh allocations are the proposed greenfield expressway connecting Jewar Airport with the Ganga Expressway, the Agra-Lucknow-Ganga Expressway link through Hardoi and Farrukhabad, the extension of the Ganga Expressway.

No saint figures in preliminary SIT findings, says Adityanath

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on Tuesday said the preliminary report of the Special Investigation Team probing the alleged embezzlement of donations at the Ram Janmabhoomi Temple in Ayodhya had found no involvement of any sadhu or saint.



in the SIT's initial report in the case related to the alleged embezzlement of offerings at the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Temple," Adityanath said.

The Chief Minister also launched a sharp attack on the Samajwadi Party and the opposition over the issue, accusing them of attempting to politicise

the matter. He described their conduct as "undemocratic and unconstitutional" and alleged that it hurt public sentiments.

"This conduct by the Samajwadi Party and the opposition is undemocratic and unconstitutional. It is also an insult to the sentiments associated with Bharat Ratna Dr Bhimrao Ambedkar," he said.

Escalating his criticism, Adityanath accused the pre-pubes Samajwadi Party government of failing to protect Ayodhya's sanctity.

"It was the Samajwadi Party government that committed the sin of staining the lanes of Shri Ayodhya Dham and the sacred flow of the Saryu with blood," he said.

Article 370: NC to observe Aug 5 as 'black day'; Cong, PDP plan protests

JAMMU: National Conference provincial president Ratan Lal Gupta on Tuesday said his party would observe August 5 as "black day" to mark the "unconstitutional and unilateral" abrogation of Jammu and Kashmir's constitutional guarantees in 2019, and to register a strong protest against the Centre's "refusal" to restore statehood.

The Congress and the Peoples Democratic Party (PDP) also announced separate protest demonstrations outside their party headquarters in Jammu to mark the seventh anniversary of the August 5, 2019 developments, when the Centre abrogated J&K's special status under Article 370

and bifurcated the erstwhile state into the Union Territories of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh. In a statement, Gupta said August 5 remains one of the "darkest days" in the constitutional and democratic history of Jammu and Kashmir.

"The decisions taken on that day stripped the people of their constitutional safeguards and were imposed without their consent, undermining the principles of democracy, federalism and constitutional propriety. The people of Jammu and Kashmir continue to bear the political, constitutional and emotional consequences of those decisions," he said.

Gupta said while the BJP has repeatedly claimed that

the downgrading of the erstwhile state was temporary, its continued reluctance to restore statehood has exposed the "hollowness" of its promises.

"The people were assured that statehood would be restored at the earliest, yet years have passed without any concrete action. Instead of fulfilling its solemn commitment, the Centre has chosen to prolong uncertainty and deny the people their legitimate democratic rights," he said.

The NC provincial president said the prolonged delay in restoring statehood has deprived J&K of the constitutional authority and administrative autonomy that every full-fledged state enjoys.

Tuberculosis incidence, mortality declined significantly from 2015-24, claims Centre

"India's TB incidence rate fell from 237 per lakh population in 2015 to 187 per lakh in 2024"

NEW DELHI: Union Health Minister JP Nadra on Tuesday said India has made significant progress in tuberculosis control, with the incidence rate declining by 21 per cent between 2015 and 2024, while over 2.29 crore diabetes cases have been reported under the national non-communicable disease programme over the past three years.

Responding to a query in the Rajya Sabha, Nadra said public health and hospitals are state subjects and the Centre provides technical and financial support to states and Union territories under the National Health Mission (NHM).

He said tuberculosis (TB) case notification has increased over the past three years, helping bridge the gap in "missing" cases. According to the Ni-kshay portal, 25.52 lakh TB cases were notified in 2023, 26.18 lakh in 2024 and 26.37 lakh in 2025.

Citing the World Health Organization's Global TB Report 2025, the minister said



JP Nadra speaks in the Rajya Sabha

India's TB incidence rate fell from 237 per lakh population in 2015 to 187 per lakh in 2024, a 21 per cent decline, compared to the global decline of 12 per cent over the same period.

The TB mortality rate also declined by 25 per cent, from 28 per lakh population in 2015 to 21 per lakh in 2024, while treatment coverage increased from 53 per cent to 92 per cent, he said. Nadra said the government has implemented two phases of the 100-day TB Muk

Centre asks regulators to step up monitoring of GLP-1 drugs

NEW DELHI: The Centre has directed drug regulators across states and Union Territories to tighten surveillance over the supply chain and promotion of GLP-1 weight-loss drugs amid concerns over surrogate advertising and misleading awareness campaigns. In a written reply in the Rajya Sabha on Tuesday, Minister of State for Health Anupriya Patel said the Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) has approved glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1) receptor agonists only for the treatment of Type 2 diabetes in adults and for chronic weight management in adults with specified medical conditions.

Bharat Abhiyaan, launched in December 2024 and March 2026, and expanded the campaign to all districts. The initiative focuses on screening high-risk populations, early diagnosis through chest X-rays and nucleic acid amplification tests, timely treatment, nutritional support and preventive therapy for vulnerable groups.

Further, the minister said the National Programme for Prevention and Control of Non-Communicable Diseases

The government has also established 524 functional day care cancer centres for decentralised chemotherapy services and approved 19 state cancer institutes and 20 tertiary care cancer centres under a central assistance scheme, he stated.

According to the NP-NCD portal, between 2023-24 and 2025-26, 2.29 crore diabetes cases, 1.53 lakh oral cancer cases, 24,969 breast cancer cases and 37,948 cervical cancer cases were reported under the programme.

Nadra said expenditure under the National TB Elimination Programme and the non-communicable disease control programme stood at Rs 6,763.85 crore in 2025-26.

He further said reductions in customs duty and GST on certain high-cost cancer drugs, along with the Pradhan Mantri Bhartiya Janaushadhi Pariyojana and AMRIT pharmacies, have improved access to affordable cancer medicines, reducing patients' out-of-pocket expenses.

'Gungi gudiya' row deepens as NCP protests, Cong cries foul

MUMBAI: The Congress on Tuesday claimed workers of ruling NCP forcibly entered its office in Mumbai with an intention to vandalise it as both sides traded charges after the Opposition party called Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Sunetra Pawar a "gungi gudiya" (mute doll).

The NCP reacted angrily to the characterization of its president Sunetra Pawar and lashed out at the Congress, which also faced criticism from ruling allies Shiv Sena and the BJP, and held a protest at the MPCC office in south Mumbai.

MPCC president Harshwardhan Sapkal alleged NCP workers forcibly entered the party office with an intention to vandalise it and asserted the Congress would continue to follow Mahatma Gandhi's path despite the provocation.

The Nationalist Congress Party (NCP), however, claimed its protest was peaceful.

Sapkal said some "goon-like elements" owing allegiance to the NCP barged into the Congress office and tried to vandalise the premises, calling it

a "cowardly attack" and a dangerous precedent in democratic politics.

"It is difficult to believe the police had no information about the arrival of the NCP workers. The Congress office had no police protection. We condemn not only the attack but also the failure of the police," he told reporters.

Sapkal alleged the police acted to protect the NCP workers instead of maintaining law and order, and claimed the BJP had instigated the incident.

He insisted the Congress was capable of retaliating, but would not abandon the values of civility and non-violence associated with Mahatma Gandhi. "If they (NCP) had informed us beforehand (of the protest), we would have welcomed them by presenting them a copy of the Constitution," Sapkal maintained.

Referring to NCP spokesperson Suraj Chavan, the state Congress chief alleged the individual who led the protest had earlier been removed from a party post by former Deputy CM late Ajit Pawar.

GULF ALLIES URGE TRUMP TO DELAY FURTHER STRIKES

Trump: New talks ‘last chance’ for Iran to reach deal, avert escalation

WASHINGTON: US President Donald Trump has played this hand before during the five-month-old Iran war -- but this time, he insists it is different.

The president on Monday said that new talks between Washington and Tehran are the “last chance” for Iran to forge a deal and avoid an escalation of US strikes on the country.

Trump, speaking at the Oval Office, said he expects negotiations will focus on reopening the Strait of Hormuz and create a pathway for Iran to address the ‘United States’ concerns about its nuclear programme. He told reporters they would likely learn about the status of the negotiations “today or tomorrow”.

“The first phase is the opening of the straits. The second phase will be the denuclearisation,” the Republican president said. “And that will take a little while.”

While Trump has revelled in the US military decimating layers of Tehran’s leadership and devastating its air force and navy, Iran is betting it can out-last Trump as he faces diminished stockpiles of munitions and the difficulty of executing a war that is unpopular with the American electorate ahead of November’s midterm election.

Trump said he decided to hold off on ordering American



A billboard depicting a fallen Statue of Liberty and crowds carrying Iranian and Shiite flags

AP

forces to carry out new massive strikes against Iran at the urging of Gulf allies Qatar, Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates.

He said a plan was in place for US forces to carry out “the biggest attack since World War II” on Sunday. But he decided to scrap the plan and give diplomacy more time to play out after hearing from key Gulf leaders -- including Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman -- as well as at the request of unnamed Iranian officials.

But Trump reiterated that he is running out of patience with Iran.

“This is the last chance for them to sign a good document,” Trump said.

Earlier on Monday, Trump had criticised Iran on social media as being “unbelievably duplicitous”.

His ire was raised by Iran claiming that its meetings with Oman on Monday were focussed solely on establishing a temporary route for safe navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, a critical waterway for the global oil trade.

“They ask for a meeting, some would say beg, talks begin, with more scheduled in the immediate future, and they say, openly and proudly, that

they are not having any discussions, that nothing is being talked about, and they are only dealing with Oman,” Trump grumbled.

Trump said whether “Iran wants to admit it or not, we are, in fact, talking” about preventing Iran from developing nuclear weapons.

Trump has threatened to escalate attacks on Iran only to edge away from his threats several times since the start of US and Israel strikes on February 28.

Asked by a reporter how Americans view him repeatedly making grim threats on Tehran before backing away,

HIGHLIGHTS

» Earlier on Monday, Trump had criticised Iran on social media as being ‘unbelievably duplicitous’

» His ire was raised by Iran claiming that its meetings with Oman on Monday were focussed solely on establishing a temporary route for safe navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, a critical waterway for the global oil trade

Trump responded that he is showing patience out of a consideration for Iranian life.

“I want to give them every last chance before decapitation,” Trump said. He added, “Hopefully, they will come to their senses.”

Trump may still come to the conclusion that a massive escalation in the conflict with Iran is necessary.

Critics say Trump’s hesitation reflects growing recognition that US military force alone may not compel Iran to back down. Trump has repeatedly threatened major strikes before stepping back, citing diplomatic progress.

AP/PTI

Russian & Ukrainian drone strikes kill 5 in each country

MOSCOW: Ukrainian drone attacks in the region around Moscow killed five people, local officials said Tuesday, while authorities in Ukraine said Russian aerial strikes there also caused at least five civilian deaths.

Since Russia’s invasion more than four years ago, Ukraine has developed long-range drones that can hit targets deep inside Russia. In the past year, they have battered oil facilities, major storage depots and other key infrastructure.

Russia’s relentless aerial attacks on Ukraine have killed more than 16,000 civilians, with casualties rising steadily each year, according to the United Nations.

Meanwhile, escalating attacks by both sides on shipping in the Black Sea has reawakened fears that global food security could be put at risk.

Russia says a Ukrainian drone killed 7 on Black Sea coast

The death toll from a drone strike Monday in the Russian Black Sea resort of Arkhipo-Osipovka rose to seven, including three children, regional authorities said.

On Tuesday morning, Krasnodar regional authorities updated the number of wounded to 58, with 21 of them hospitalised.

Footage circulating online showed a drone slamming into a crowded beach, with what sounded like rapid gun-



fire ringing in the background. Ukraine has not commented on the strike.

Ukrainian drones attack near Moscow and St Petersburg

A Ukrainian drone attack in the Moscow region, which surrounds but doesn’t include the Russian capital, killed five people and wounded 10 others on Tuesday morning, the region’s governor Andrei Vorobyov said.

Most damage from the attack occurred in the Chekhov municipal district, where several fires erupted at the Novoselki industrial zone, Vorobyov said.

In the latest string of attacks on Russia’s biggest online retailer, Wildberries said Tuesday that its warehouse in the Leningrad region, which lies adjacent to St. Petersburg, was on fire.

In the Tver region, located between Moscow and St. Petersburg, drone debris inflicted “partial” damage on a wall of a Wildberries warehouse in the village of Emmaus, the region’s governor Vitaly

Korolyov said.

Ukrainian drones have over the past 18 days targeted 15 Wildberries warehouses, 13 of which have caught fire, Ukraine’s Unmanned Systems Forces commander Robert Brovdi said. Ukrainian officials say the company provides goods that can be used by the Russian military. Kyiv is also keen to unsettle the Russian public with high-profile attacks. Overall, the Russian Defense Ministry reported Tuesday morning that its air defenses shot down 320 Ukrainian drones overnight.

Russia hammers Ukrainian ports and shipping

The Russian Defence Ministry said in a statement Tuesday that its forces the previous night “continued to strike Ukrainian ports, vessels, and port infrastructure” used by Kyiv’s army. Russian attacks across Ukraine killed at least six people and injured more than 20, officials said. Strikes hit Mykolaiv, Odesa, Sumy, Kharkiv and Kramatorsk, damaging civilian and military infrastructure.

AP/PTI

Sudanese army drone strike hits court in Darfur, killing at least 35

CAIRO: At least 35 people were killed in a Sudanese army drone strike on a civil court in Sudan’s Darfur region, a rights group said.

Emergency Lawyers, an independent group documenting atrocities in Sudan, said on Sunday afternoon drones targeted the headquarters of the civil court in Al-Zawiya Gara village in North Darfur State, “a civilian facility that plays a judicial and social role in the region”.

“Directing attacks against civilians and civilian objects constitutes a grave violation of international humanitarian

“DRONE WARFARE HAS BECOME A SIGNATURE IN THE COUNTRY’S BATTLE, WITH BOTH SIDES CARRYING OUT STRIKES”

law,” said the group in a statement, and demanded an investigation.

Sudan plunged into all-out war in April 2023, between the paramilitary Rapid Support Forces and the Sudanese military, leaving at least

59,000 people killed, according to Armed Conflict Location and Event Data, a conflict-monitoring group. Aid groups say the figure is an undercount and the true number could be many times higher. Drone warfare has become a signature in the country’s battle, with both sides carrying out strikes. It is now the leading cause of death in Sudan, according to the United Nations, accounting for 80 per cent of civilian deaths during the first four months of 2026.

The Sudanese army did not respond to requests for comment.

AP/PTI

Ebola kills 1,700 in eastern Congo

BUNIA(CONGO): Ebola has killed more than 1,700 people in eastern Congo in the fastest-growing outbreak of the disease, data showed.

As of Tuesday, 3,802 cases had been recorded, with 1,707 deaths, according to the latest government update. It is not clear when the outbreak will reach its peak, Africa CDC Director-General Dr Jean Kaseya said during his second visit to the town of Bunia near the outbreak’s epicentre on Tuesday. Kaseya cautioned that nearly 80 per cent of new cases are not coming from contact tracing but instead from community spread.

The outbreak, declared on May 15, has been linked to the Bun-

diguyo virus for which there are no approved vaccines or treatments. Delays in contact tracing, difficulties accessing affected areas, mistrust from communities, and violence by armed groups and some residents have hampered the response, the Africa CDC has said.

The outbreak is mostly concentrated in eastern Congo’s remote Ituri province, which accounts for nearly 90 per cent of cases, but cases have also been confirmed in five other provinces, including in one of the country’s largest cities, Kisangani. Neighbouring Uganda declared itself free of Ebola following the discharge of the country’s last patient in mid-June.

On Monday, healthcare work-

ers in the hard hit town of Mongwalu issued an ultimatum over unpaid wages saying that “if nothing is done within 24 hours, we will escalate our action.”

A key challenge is that patient zero has yet to be identified in the outbreak while displacement from armed conflict and illegal mining in the region have made it difficult to trace thousands who have come in contact with infected individuals.

The Ebola outbreak in eastern Congo has killed more people faster than previous outbreaks, while healthcare strikes, funding shortages, attacks on health centres and community mistrust hamper the response.

AP/PTI

Man from El Salvador dies in immigration jail in New Jersey: ICE

WASHINGTON: A 41-year-old man from El Salvador has died at Delaney Hall immigration detention centre in Newark, New Jersey, amid months of protests over conditions and medical care, US officials said Monday.

Edwin Lopez-Cornejo, who had been detained since June 18 after being accused of entering the US illegally, died Saturday, according to US Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE). His cause of death will be determined after further medical examination. ICE said he received proper medical care.

The death is the second at the 1,000-bed facility since President Donald Trump began his second term. At least 56 people have died in ICE custody during the period, according to Associated Press tracking. Democratic Senator Cory Booker called for Delaney Hall to be permanently closed, citing poor conditions.

AP/PTI

GOVERNMENT OF NATIONAL CAPITAL TERRITORY OF DELHI
HEADQUARTERS: DELHI FIRE SERVICE: NEW DELHI-110001

Notice for Invitation of Applications for Third Party Auditors

Applications are hereby invited from the eligible Third-Party Auditors for their registration and empanelment with Principal Director of Delhi Fire Service as Fire Safety Auditor (Third Party).

In pursuance of the provisions contained in Delhi Fire Service (Amendment) Rule 2025, "Fire Safety Auditors" as specified in rule -- (iv-a) read with Rule 35, 36, 37 and 38 of the said rules are authorised to issue Forms H, I, J and K for compliance of the provisions contained in these Rules.

The eligible and qualified persons or association of persons or companies are hereby informed to apply on Form "U" (<https://dfs.delhi.gov.in/dfs/forms>) along with all requisite and mandatory documents on e-mail director.dlfire@nic.in to the Principal Director, Delhi Fire Service for their registration / empanelment to act as a Fire Safety Auditors categorically mentioning the subject as "Application for registration / empanelment as Fire Safety Auditor under DFS (Amendment) Rules- 2025".

For details of eligibility please refer schedule VII of Delhi Fire Service (Amended) Rules 2025 (https://dfs.delhi.gov.in/sites/default/files/Dfs/dfs_amendment_rules_2025.pdf).

Sh. Mukesh Verma, Divisional Officer (Mobile No. 9810445332) is the Nodal Officer for any query/ clarification.

(Sachin Rana)
IAS
Principal Director

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0161/26-27.

Six killed in Sri Lanka as heavy rain triggers landslides, floods

COLOMBO: At least six persons were killed and three others injured as heavy rain, landslides and flash floods battered parts of Sri Lanka over the past two days, officials said on Tuesday.

The adverse weather has affected five districts, with incessant downpours triggering landslides, flooding and strong winds, disrupting normal life and forcing nearly 1,900 people into relief centres.

Police said three women, aged 83, 58 and 47, and a 22-year-old man were killed when a mound of earth collapsed onto a house.

Three people were killed and another went missing after heavy rains triggered flooding, while schools remained closed across the Central Province as authorities warned of further danger.

AP/PTI

Ethiopia landslide kills 14 at monastery ritual

ADDIS ABABA: A landslide triggered by heavy rainfall in Ethiopia's Amhara region killed 14 people and injured seven others on Monday, while an unknown number remain missing as search and rescue operations continue.

The landslide struck Tsadqane Debre Mitmaq St Mary Monastery, where hundreds of worshippers had gathered for a holy water cleansing ritual popular among those seeking spiritual healing for chronic illnesses. Massive rocks broke loose from a nearby mountain and crashed onto the worshippers, officials said. The dead included 11 people who were buried at the monastery, while the remains of others were sent to their hometowns. Some victims remained difficult to identify.

The injured were taken to Debre Birhan, about 70 km from the monastery.

AP/PTI

Palestinians hold mass funeral for 112 bodies finally recovered from '23 strike

DEIR AL-BALAH(GAZA CITY): Palestinians gathered on Tuesday for a mass funeral of more than 100 bodies finally recovered from a deadly Israeli strike in Gaza in 2023. More than 300 people were killed on November 22, 2023, weeks into the war with Hamas, when warplanes flattened a residential block in Gaza City's Sabra neighbourhood.

Around 40 bodies were recovered soon afterward in a frantic scramble of rough

tools and bare hands, but most were buried deep beneath the rubble.

Reports of the high number of victims in one of the war's deadliest attacks took days to reach the public in the chaos just before its first ceasefire.

Over the weekend, first responders dug through the destroyed buildings and recovered remains of 112 victims, including 40 children, according to the Civil Defence, a rescue agency operating

under the Hamas-run Interior Ministry.

It said 157 bodies still have not been found.

Bodies of Palestinians killed in the war's early months are being recovered from rubble in Gaza under the fragile ceasefire, adding to the territory's rising death toll. At least 7,400 people remain missing, while widespread destruction, displacement, poor living conditions and repeated ceasefire violations continue to hamper recovery efforts.

AP/PTI

SEVERE DROUGHT DISRUPTS SHIPPING

Nazi warship wrecks emerge from Danube River amid severe drought

PRAHOVO (SERBIA): War levels on the Danube River, the second longest in Europe, have dropped so low because of drought that the hulks of dozens of World War II German battleships are emerging into view.

They are a curious distraction from the summer heat crisis. The Danube's record low water levels also have forced power plants to the brink of shutting down, and governments across Central and Eastern Europe are taking steps to conserve electricity.

In the middle of the river separating Serbia and Romania near the Serbian port of Prahovo, a rusty hull is now visible along with a broken mast where the Nazi flag used to fly.

The ships, some still laden with weapons, belonged to Nazi Germany's Black Sea fleet that the Germans deliberately sank as they retreated from Romania and as Soviet forces advanced deeper



into Europe near the end of the war.

Historians say up to 200 German warships were scuttled in September 1944 near Prahovo in the Danube gorge as they came under Soviet fire. The idea behind the deliberate sinking was to slow down the Soviet advance in the Bal-

kans. But Nazi Germany surrendered months later, in May 1945. The sight of the old warships is a reminder that the Serbian government, with European Union financial support, has long been trying to do something about them. Some were removed from the river by

“Some were removed from the river by Communist Yugoslav authorities, but most have remained because of the explosives they carried”

Communist Yugoslav authorities, but most have remained because of the explosives they carried.

Now, however, authorities are trying to keep traffic flowing on the Danube, which flows through 10 nations, as the dropping water levels create dangerous conditions. Experts have linked the unusually hot weather to global warming and other factors.

Krsta Brandic, a Prahovo resident, said the low water levels have almost stopped ship traffic: “As you can see, the (big) ships can't pass anymore.”

AP/PTI

Indian economy to hit \$5-trillion mark in FY29 as per IMF, says FM

‘The govt has adopted a growth strategy focused on enhancing agri productivity, promoting mfg, supporting MSMEs & expanding infra’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Indian economy is set to cross \$5-trillion mark in FY29 as per the International Monetary Fund (IMF) and the government has adopted a broad-based growth strategy to achieve the milestone, Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said in the Rajya Sabha on Tuesday.

As per the World Economic Outlook database (April 2026) published by the IMF, India's GDP at current prices is projected to be around \$5.1 trillion by 2028-29, she said in a written reply.

“The government has adopted a broad-based growth strategy focusing on enhancing agricultural productivity, promoting manufacturing, supporting MSMEs, expanding infrastructure, improving logistics and ease of doing business, creating an efficient and streamlined tax system through income tax and GST reforms, fostering innovation and digitalisation, strengthening human capital, & ensuring energy security,” Sitharaman said.

The strategy is complemented by sustained emphasis on public capital expenditure, liberalising the FDI regime,



Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman

The strategy is complemented by sustained emphasis on public capex, liberalising FDI and boosting exports, she said

boosting exports, and strengthening macroeconomic fundamentals through prudent fiscal management and price stability. In addition, she said, the government is strengthening trade resilience by expanding its network of Free Trade Agreements (FTAs) and Comprehensive Economic Partnership/Cooperation Agreements.

To develop the manufacturing sector, she said, initia-

HIGHLIGHTS

» In addition, she said, the government is strengthening trade resilience by expanding its network of Free Trade Agreements

» To develop the manufacturing sector, initiatives like PLI, Make in India, National Logistics Policy, etc are aimed at boosting domestic production

» Collectively, the finance minister said, these measures are expected to boost India's medium-term growth prospects

tives such as Production Linked Incentives (PLI) scheme, Make in India, National Logistics Policy, National Single Window System and PM GatiShakti, scheme are aimed at enhancing domestic production, attracting investment, generating employment and improving competitiveness.

These efforts are complemented by targeted measures to strengthen the MSME sec-

tor, including enhancement of guarantees and the Emergency Credit Guarantee Scheme, revision of MSME classification norms, strengthening the Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS) ecosystem, simplified Udyam Registration, wider access to Government e-Marketplace (GeM), and support under the PM Vishwakarma Scheme, the minister said.

The services sector is being strengthened through the development and deployment of Digital Public Infrastructure, promotion of Global Capability Centres (GCCs), Medical Value Travel and the Orange Economy, strengthening the artificial intelligence and digital ecosystem, and targeted initiatives for skill development and enhancing workforce employability, she said.

The Union Budget 2026-27 has announced a number of initiatives to unlock the growth potential of the services sector, including the establishment of the National Institute of Hospitality, creation of Regional Medical Hubs, expansion of Allied Health Professional institutions, development of AVGC (Animation, Visual Effects, Gaming and Comics) Content Creator Labs, and support for university

townships, she said.

In agriculture, she said, the focus is on improving productivity through facilitating investments in irrigation, technology adoption, digital agriculture, crop diversification, post-harvest infrastructure and better market access.

The Union Budgets in recent years have also identified and emphasised on strategic sectors such as semiconductors, electronics, biopharmaceuticals, rare earths, chemicals, capital goods, clean energy and advanced manufacturing as important drivers for growth, Sitharaman said.

These initiatives are complemented by the Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs (PM-SETU) scheme, which aims to strengthen industry-aligned skilling and create a future-ready workforce for these emerging sectors, she added.

Collectively, the finance minister said, these measures are expected to strengthen India's medium-term growth prospects and support its long-term vision of Viksit Bharat by 2047.

PAC flags confusion over IGST exemption on pharma imports

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: The Public Accounts Committee (PAC) of Parliament has expressed deep concern regarding the lack of clarity in the implementation of the IGST exemption on imported pharmaceuticals due to inadequate coordination within the tax department and poor dissemination of information related to tax notices. In its 53rd report presented to the Parliament on Tuesday, the parliamentary panel assessed the steps taken by the Ministry of Finance regarding the recommendations made by it in the previous report about the improper exemption of IGST on pharmaceutical imports. While appreciating the government for adhering to all four recommendations in the original report, the committee highlighted the need for further clarity and technology support in the taxation system.

During the audit process, two cases were found, wherein some importers had benefited from the IGST exemption for drugs and pharmaceutical goods imported through customs in Mumbai during the period between November 2017 and March 2018. While one customs authority agreed with the results of the audit and started recovering the dues, the other upheld the exemption, thereby making a different interpretation of the laws.

The dispute arose after the implementation of the GST system in July 2017, which saw several changes made in the tax



structure concerning imports of publicly funded research institutions and other scientific bodies.

It was observed by the parliamentary panel that the repetitive issuance of notifications and clarifications by the finance ministry was due to poor coordination between different wings of the department. It was further observed with deep regret that even after the Tax Research Unit (TRU), which is the only entity authorised to issue customs as well as GST notifications, is the only authority to do so, there is still much confusion at the implementation stage.

It is pertinent to note here that the PAC strongly advocated that every notification be supported by illustrative examples to eliminate ambiguity from it. Furthermore, the PAC suggested the development of a searchable repository containing all the relevant notifications, circulars, judicial precedents, and clarifications. It also suggested the setting up of an online portal wherein assesses can get instant clarification on technical aspects.

In response to these observations of the committee, the finance ministry has said that

all notifications, rules, circulars, and guidelines are already accessible on the CBIC's portal for tax information, and the recommendations have been noted for compliance. But then, the committee observed that the government had not taken any steps with regard to making a platform for dealing with queries of field officers.

The report discusses the history of the taxation system for imports of scientific and technical equipment by the publicly funded institutions for research. Before the introduction of GST, the importation of such equipment was exempted from certain additional customs duties as per Notification No. 51/96.

However, post GST, the government made a change in the notification so that the exemptions could be availed even for IGST. Moreover, it has been observed that in 2022, the government removed the exemption offered to publicly funded institutions, universities, Indian Institutes of Technology (IITs), the Indian Institute of Science, and certain other institutes recommended by the GST Council.

The parliamentary panel also maintained that the research institutions that are engaged in research in sciences, technologies, and medicine have an important contribution to make in furthering public good and deserve some financial assistance. This especially applies to institutions doing research in cancer and medicines that save lives.

Adani Power promoter sells 12.4 cr shares for ₹2,627 cr to Adani Infra

NEW DELHI: A promoter group entity of Adani Power on Tuesday sold 12.48 crore shares of the company to Adani Infra (India) Ltd for Rs 2,627 crore through open market transactions.

According to the block deal data on the National Stock Exchange (NSE), Ardour Investment Holding Ltd, a promoter entity, offloaded 12,48,00,000 shares, representing a 0.65 per cent stake in Adani Power Ltd.

The shares were disposed of at an average price of Rs 210.50 apiece, taking the deal size to Rs 2,627.04 crore.

Following the latest transaction, Ardour Investment Holding Ltd's stakeholding in Adani Power has declined to 3.03 per cent from 3.68 per cent.

Meanwhile, Adani Infra (India) Ltd purchased an equal number of shares at the same price.

Shares of Adani Power fell nearly 2 per cent to close at Rs 209.95 on the NSE.

On Monday, Adani Infra (India) Ltd, a promoter group entity of Adani Green Energy Ltd, bought a 1.03 per cent stake from another promoter arm, Ardour Investment Holding Ltd, for Rs 2,380 crore.

Prior to this, in June this year, Adani Infra acquired 2.15 crore equity shares or a 1.31 per cent stake in Adani Green Energy from Ardour Investment Holding for Rs 3,246 crore.

Bharti Airtel reports increase of 37.3% in Q1 net profit to ₹8,167 cr

NEW DELHI: Bharti Airtel on Tuesday reported a 37.3 per cent year-on-year increase in consolidated profit after tax (PAT) to Rs 8,167 crore for the June quarter, supported by strong growth across its India and Africa operations.

The company had posted a net profit of Rs 5,948 crore in the year-ago period.

Revenue from operations during the quarter rose 18.3 per cent to Rs 58,539 crore from Rs 49,462.6 crore in the corresponding quarter last year.

The company said revenues grew 18.4 per cent year-on-year and 5.7 per cent sequentially, driven by strong performance in India and Africa businesses, the company said in a statement.

Airtel's consolidated customer base increased 12.5



per cent year-on-year to 60.5 crore, while its India subscriber base grew 12.8 per cent to 43.6 crore. Average revenue per user (ARPU) in India rose 5.6 per cent to Rs 264 from Rs 250 a year ago.

India revenues increased 9.7 per cent to Rs 41,214 crore, led by premiumisation in mobile services and strong growth in Homes and Airtel Business.

India Mobile revenue grew

9.2 per cent year-on-year, supported by higher customer additions and improved ARPU.

The company added 1 million postpaid customers during the quarter, taking its post-paid base to 30 million, while its smartphone data customer base grew 21.1 million over the past year.

Data consumption per customer increased 27.7 per cent to 34.4 GB from 26.9 GB a year ago. Airtel's consolidated capex stood at Rs 13,386 crore, including Rs 9,698 crore in India. The company deployed 1,579 towers and 14,540 mobile broadband base stations during the quarter.

Net debt declined around 35 per cent to Rs 81,852 crore from Rs 1,25,489 crore a year ago.

AGENCIES

ONGC Q1 net profit rises 112% to ₹17,034 cr

Profit before tax rose to a record quarterly high of Rs 22,848 crore



The Standalone gross revenue rose 45.2% to Rs 46,460 crore in Q1 FY27, from Rs 32,003 crore in Q1 FY26

\$66.13 per barrel a year earlier. In rupee terms, the realisation increased 66.5 per cent to Rs 9,419 per barrel.

ONGC also saw a signif-

icant contribution from new well gas. Revenue from new well gas stood at Rs 3,998 crore during Q1FY27, generating an additional Rs 1,897 crore compared with the APM gas price. New well gas accounted for around 38 per cent of total revenue from ONGC's nomination gas portfolio.

At the consolidated level, gross revenue rose 25.7 per cent year-on-year to Rs 2,04,987 crore. Consolidated profit after tax, however, declined 43.3 per cent to Rs 6,554 crore, primarily due to a consolidated net loss of Rs 12,265 crore reported by HPCL. ONGC said the loss was largely attributable to under-recoveries on petroleum products following the sharp increase in crude oil prices amid the West Asia crisis.

Production remained

broadly flat during the quarter, with standalone crude oil production at 4.452 million tonnes and natural gas production at 4.756 billion cubic metres.

To support future production growth, ONGC has more than Rs 40,000 crore of projects under implementation in the Western Offshore. The company expects benefits from these investments to progressively materialise from FY28, supporting higher production and improved recovery.

Meanwhile, under the Samudra Manthan initiative, ONGC spudded its first deepwater exploratory well in the Mahanadi basin on July 25, 2026, at a water depth of around 765 metres, strengthening its focus on offshore exploration and long-term energy security.

ANI

PSPCL to hold stakeholder consultation meets on Aug 7

PATIALA: Punjab State Power Corporation Ltd (PSPCL) will hold stakeholder consultation-cum-grievance redressal meetings in five districts on August 7 to address consumer issues & improve power services.

The meetings will be led by PSPCL Chairman-cum-Managing Director Dr. Basant Garg, along with all four directors. Garg has directed the directors to visit their assigned districts, interact with consumers, hear grievances on priority and resolve issues wherever possible.

The initiative will provide a common platform for the public, industrial and commercial consumers, and industry associations to raise complaints and suggestions.



Dr. Basant Garg, Chairman & Managing Director, PSPCL

Directors will also review pending cases, issue directions to field officers for timely resolution, and submit detailed reports to the CMD on issues discussed, action taken and matters requiring further intervention. Garg urged consumers to actively participate in the meetings.

MPOST

L&T bags ultra-mega order of over ₹15,000 cr from ADNOC Offshore

NEW DELHI: L&T Energy Hydrocarbon Offshore (LTEH Offshore) secured an ultra-mega order from ADNOC Offshore for a major project located in the Middle East.

According to the company, under L&T's project classification system, an order rated as "Ultra-Mega" carries a total value exceeding Rs 15,000 crore. Other project tiers include Significant (Rs 1,000-2,500 cr), Large (Rs 2,500-5,000 cr), Major (Rs 5,000-10,000 cr), and Mega (Rs 10,000-15,000 cr).

The project involves the development of multiple offshore facilities. LTEH Offshore will serve as the lead partner in a consortium arrangement through which the development



works will be executed. As the lead partner, LTEH Offshore will execute the major share of the project scope, covering engineering, procurement, construction, installation, and commissioning (EPCIC) of the offshore facilities, along with upgrading existing facilities.

A significant portion of the fabrication work will take place at L&T's fabrication yards,

leveraging the company's integrated EPCIC capabilities and track record in delivering offshore developments across the region. LTEH Offshore functions as an EPCIC solutions provider for the offshore oil and gas industry, supported by in-house engineering capabilities, fabrication facilities, and a fleet of marine vessels.

Commenting on the order win, S.N Subrahmanyam, Chairman & MD - L&T Ltd, said, "This prestigious award from ADNOC reflects the trust our clients place in L&T's engineering excellence, project execution capabilities and unwavering commitment to delivering complex energy infrastructure projects safely & on schedule."

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



Jupiter Wagons Ltd has partnered with Italy's Lucchini RS Holding SpA to develop an integrated railwheel manufacturing platform. Under the deal, Lucchini RS will acquire a 15% stake in Jupiter Tatravagonka Railwheel Factory Pvt Ltd (JTRWF), while Italian government-backed financial institution SIMEST SpA will acquire a 10% stake. The combined 25% stake is valued at ₹28 million (about Rs 307 crore). The partnership aims to manufacture railway wheels, axles and wheelsets across the entire value chain, from raw material processing to finished products, it said.

MPOST

Smart standards to cut compliance burden: Nidhi Khare

‘The move would improve accuracy & traceability while reducing testing costs for MSMEs’

NEW DELHI: Consumer Affairs Secretary Nidhi Khare on Tuesday said the government is working to introduce "smart standards" that are machine-readable & more accurate to cut the compliance burden on industry, with the initiative targeted for completion by World Standards Day on October 14.

Addressing FICCI MASS-MERIZE 2026, Khare stressed that improving quality standards is essential for India's manufacturing growth. "We cannot grow unless we address quality concerns in our manufacturing processes and the way products are sold to consum-



ers," she said, noting a rise in consumer complaints.

She said the Department of Consumer Affairs will, for the first time under the Legal Metrology Act, issue Improve-

ment Notices to manufacturers and retailers, allowing them to rectify minor violations before cases are taken up for compounding.

Khare also highlighted the

need to strengthen the country's testing infrastructure by adopting artificial intelligence and robotics. The move, she said, would improve accuracy and traceability while reducing testing costs for MSMEs.

Jeyandran Venugopal, Chair of the FICCI Retail and Internal Trade Committee and President & CEO of Reliance Retail Ventures Ltd., said businesses must adapt to changing consumer behaviour, particularly the preferences of Gen Z, by aligning products with evolving needs.

Manish Anandani, Co-Chair of the FICCI FMCG

Committee and Managing Director of Kenvue India, said India's FMCG sector continues to drive inclusive growth, supported by rising consumer aspirations, digital adoption and innovation.

FICCI Director General Jyoti Vij said consumers increasingly expect quality, transparency, convenience and sustainable choices, prompting businesses to rely on technology and innovation to stay competitive.

During the event, FICCI and Deloitte released the report, "Consumer Trends: IGNITEing Growth & Governance."

MPOST

MUMBAI: Castrol India Ltd on Tuesday reported strong financial results for the April-June quarter (Q2) and first half (H1) of 2026 despite supply disruptions and severe commodity inflation, driven by supply chain agility, brand strength and disciplined execution across its businesses.

For the April-June quarter (Q2), revenue from operations rose 25 per cent year-on-year to Rs 1,871 crore, while EBITDA increased 41 per cent to Rs 494 crore. Profit after tax (PAT) grew 43 per cent to Rs 348 crore.

For the first half (H1) of 2026, revenue from operations

For the first half (H1) of 2026, the company's PAT increased 24 per cent to Rs 590 crore

stood at Rs 3,417 crore, up 17 per cent year-on-year. EBITDA rose 25 per cent to Rs 823 crore, while PAT increased 24 per cent to Rs 590 crore.

Managing Director Saugata Basuray said the company delivered strong volume growth across its industrial, institutional and consumer businesses, with

premium personal mobility brands outperforming the rest of the portfolio. He said Castrol leveraged its global supply chain and diversified vendor base to ensure uninterrupted supplies despite raw material challenges. Looking ahead, the company remains cautious due to inflationary pressures and uneven monsoon conditions that could affect demand in the second half of 2026, while continuing to invest in brands, distribution & customer relationships.

The board declared an interim dividend of Rs 6.25 per share, payable on or before September 2, 2026.

MPOST

Continental event already on mind as boxing, para stars return to grand welcome

The para athletics contin-



Ruby White in an international

“I trained for only three weeks before the Games after

Boxer Sachin Siwach credited months of hard work and correcting technical flaws for India's successful campaign.

— **Sakshi Chaudhary:**
CWG gold-winning boxer

challenge because we'll face stronger opponents from countries like Kazakhstan and Uzbekistan, but we'll be ready." AGENCIES

"The five javelin superstars, who have won the last four editions of the Olympic Games and World Championships, will be present at Athletissima



fourth at the Doha Diamond League in June before improving to 85.83m to claim silver at the Commonwealth Games.

“Although we always want

The Sri Lankan has a personal best of 92.62m, achieved at the Golden Gala Pietro Mennea in Roma in June this year, making him the only thrower to breach the 90m mark this season.

Men's singles world cham-

pion Shi Yuqi of China and South Korea's women's singles star An Se Young are the top seeds.

"When I won the All England, a few months later they moved from 15 to 7. It took me time because I was one of those players who was a stroke player. I wanted time to get adjusted. It took me a year to come back," Gopichand said. "And then by



the time I was kind of settling in, they brought us back to the long form and it was a death blow. Because you train, you detrain, and your endurance drops. Then to go back and play 15 was impossible. These definitely make a big impact. A few players, it will wipe off, a few

According to the national coach, doubles players are likely to feel the biggest impact as shorter games will make every phase of the contest more critical. AGENCIES

"Two stress fractures in my left foot. A dream paused. A season over," he added. In his emotional outpouring, Shirse conceded that his Asian Games, beginning on September 19 in Japan, dreams are

Auqib Nabi is set to feature in Sri Lanka series

Nabi's long-awaited India call-up came on Monday when the selectors named him as injured Jasprit Bumrah's replacement in the upcoming two-Test series in Sri Lanka beginning August 15.

batters defend and still find a way to get them out. "Does the bowler have the ability to get out the batters, the top-quality batters, or while defending? This is the other quality you seek," he said. Pathan has seen Nabil produce that kind of bowling against high-quality batters in domestic cricket, including in the Ranji Trophy final when they pipped Karnataka on first innings lead to clinch a historic maiden title earlier this year.

ferent pitches, the top-quality batsmen defend and get dismissed. That means he has the ability," Pathan said. AGENCIES

In the men's final later Monday, third-seeded Taylor Fritz defeated Rafael Nadal 7-6 (2), 6-4. Fritz broke the Spaniard twice early in the second set and eventually converted his fifth championship point after letting four earlier opportunities slip away. Fritz lay on the court for several moments after winning the 11th title of his career, then got to his feet with a roll of his eyes as the tension of finally closing out the match gave way. **AGENCIES**

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, लातेहार ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना। संख्या – EE/RDSD/LATEHAR/28/2026-27						
1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी:						
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1	लातेहार जिला के प्रखण्ड चंदवा अन्तर्गत लघुपट्ट पंचायत के ग्राम आराम में विलदिरि नदी पर पुल निर्माण।	3,59,53,700	7,19,500	10,000	18 माह	
2. निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि – 05.08.2026 3. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय – दिनांक 17.08.2026 से दिनांक 08.09.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक। 4. ई-निविदा खोलने का स्थान – कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, लातेहार। 5. ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय – 10.09.2026 अपराह्न 1:00 बजे 6. ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता- कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, लातेहार। 7. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० – 086565796434 8. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है तदनुसार अग्रधन की राशि देय होगी। 9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रधन की राशि केवल Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकृत होगी। 10. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रधन की राशि का ई-भुगतान जिस खाते से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रधन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बंद कर दिया जाय है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदारी आपकी होगी। 11. बिना कारण बताये किसी एक या सभी कार्यों की निविदा को रद्द करने का अधिकार अधोहस्ताक्षरी के पास सुरक्षित होगा। 12. कार्य हेतु आवश्यक लघु खोजियां का क्रय खनन विभाग द्वारा अनुज्ञा प्राप्त पट्टेदारों से ई-परिचलन चालान के माध्यम से करना होगा तथा संबंधित खनन पदाधिकारी द्वारा सत्यापन के उपरान्त ही विपत्रों का भुगतान किया जायेगा। अन्यथा चालान के बिना संवेदकों को खनन नहीं किया जायेगा। 13. विभाग द्वारा आवंटन प्राप्त नहीं होने की स्थिति में भी संवेदकों द्वारा निर्माण कार्य को अवरुद्ध नहीं किया जायेगा, आवंटन प्राप्त होने पर ही संवेदकों को भुगतान किया जायेगा। विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये वेबसाईट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।						



यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण

प्रथम तल, कॉमर्शियल कॉम्प्लेक्स, ओमेगा - 1 (पी - 2), ग्रेटर नौएडा

Toll Free No. 18001808296, वेबसाइट : www.yamunaexpresswayauthority.com

Request for Proposal (RFP)

For Selection of Architectural Design Consultancy for YEIDA Central Office (Phase-II) and PMC Services for Phase-I & Phase - II for Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority

Detailed RFP document is available on the E-Procurement Portal of Government of UP [<https://etender.up.nic.in/>] from **05.08.2026**. The authority seeks Selection of Architectural Design Consultancy for YEIDA Central Office (Phase-II) and PMC Services for Phase-I & Phase-II for Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority.

Interested Applicants are required to submit their proposal online on the E-procurement website on or before **01.09.2026, 1700 hrs (IST)**. In case of any queries, the Bidders are invited to contact on the following email id: yeida.planning@gmail.com.

GM (Planning), YEIDA

यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण के अधिसूचित क्षेत्र में प्राधिकरण द्वारा स्वीकृत मास्टर प्लान के अतिरिक्त प्लॉटिंग/हाउसिंग/कॉलोनी या किसी भी प्रकार का अन्य निर्माण पूरी तरह से अवैध है। सामान्यजन इस प्रकार की खरीददफरोख्त से पूर्णतः सचेत रहें तथा कॉलोनाइजर के भ्रामक विज्ञापन से बचें। अधिक जानकारी के लिए प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइट www.yamunaexpresswayauthority.com देखें।

first WTA singles title

WASHINGTON: Alexandra Eala's breakthrough week at the DC Open lasted one day longer than expected. By the time it ended, the Filipino expression written across the Nike T-shirt she had worn earlier that week had become a reality.

"Once it grows, it cannot be stopped."

After the women's final stretched across two days because of heavy rain, Eala rallied past Jessica Pegula 4-6, 6-4, 6-0 Monday to capture her first career WTA Tour title. The victory made the 21-year-old Eala the first Filipina to win a singles title on the tour, completing the same career-defining breakthrough that the Washington tournament once gave Pegula when she claimed her first WTA title in 2019. "At the beginning of the week, there's no way I would have thought that I would be holding this trophy," Eala said. "Winning a 500 (level tournament) is insane. It's an incredible milestone for me."

In the men's final later Monday, third-seeded Taylor Fritz defeated Rafael Nadal 7-6 (2), 6-4. Fritz broke the Spaniard twice early in the second set and eventually converted his fifth championship point after letting four earlier opportunities slip away. Fritz lay on the court for several moments after winning the 11th title of his career, then got to his feet with a roll of his eyes as the tension of finally closing out the match gave way. **AGENCIAS**

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

Tender Notice No.: TRD-RNC-26-27-08, dated 03.08.2026, Tender is invited by Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (TRD), S.E.Railway, Ranchi-834003 for and on behalf of the President of India for the following work. **Name of work:** "Modification of OHE due to Yard remodelling with additional two loop lines between line no. 7 & 8 and increase in length of existing saloon siding with crossover facility for to and from movement in UP & DN line at Ranchi." **Tender Value:** ₹ 2,05,60,439.87. **EMD value:** ₹ 4,11,200/- **Tender closing date & time:** 27.08.2026 at 15.00 hrs. Tenderers can visit the website www.ireps.gov.in for online tendering (PR-568)

North Eastern Railway

Open Tender Notice No.: NER-BSBSN1-T-OT-39-2026 "Open Tenders" through online (E-Tendering) are invited by Divisional Railway Manager (Signal & Telecomm) Varanasi/N.E. Railway for and behalf of the President of India for the following works: S.N.: 1, Tender Notice No. and Description of Work : NER-BSBSN1-T-OT-39-2026 : Name of Work : Provision of Interlocking of 06 Nos. Level Crossing gates in BSB Division, Approx. Value : Rs. 3,21,12,681.34, Earnest Money : Rs. 6,42,300.00, Cost of Tender Form : Rs. 00.00, Completion Period : 09Months, Tender Closing Date & Time : 25.08.2026 upto 15.00 Hrs. 1. Tender Notice will be submitted up to 15.00 Hrs. on date 25.08.2026. 2. For full details and submission of bid kindly visit the official website of Indian Railways i.e. www.ireps.gov.in. Divl. Rly. Manager (S&T) CPRO/Sig-88 N.E. Railway, Varanasi **Do not travel with Inflammable article in train**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Karamveer @ Deepak S/o Jalveer R/o 485, A-Block, Sahbad Dairy, Delhi Also at: D-267, Relief Camp, Peeragarhi, Delhi & Village Mubarkapur Dabas, Valmiki Mohalla, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 334/2015, U/S 397/394/34 IPC, PS Mundka, Outer Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Karamveer @ Deepak** the said accused of **FIR No. 334/2015, U/S 397/394/34 IPC, PS Mundka, Outer Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Pooja Talwar
Additional Sessions Judge (FTC)-01
West Distt., Room No.-313,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/10804/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY

INVITATION OF TENDERS
THROUGH E-PROCUREMENT SYSTEM

Tender Notice No. 32/2026-2027 Dated: 04.08.2026

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01/19260618	SET OF DRIVE ASSEMBLY COMPONENT	51 SET	29.08.26
02/07260204	CONTROL ARM ASSEMBLY	5015 NOS	08.09.26

NOTE -1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details.
2. No Manual offer will be entertained.

2686/26

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

CHHATTISGARH STATE POWER TRANSMISSION COMPANY LIMITED
(A Govt. of Chhattisgarh Undertaking) GSTN-22AADCS573E1XZ CIN-U40108CT2003SGC015820
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR (LINE)
Block-4, Near CSPITCL Dispensary, Daganai, Raipur (C.G.). Website: www.cspc.co.in
E-Mail- ce.eht@cspe.co.in Phone no. 0771 - 2574221, 2574224 Fax No.2574222
ED/Line/Works/EE-I/TR-1164/1041 Raipur, Date: 04.08.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through E-bidding module of SAP-SRM)
Online bids are invited for following EHV work on labour contract basis as detailed here under:

TR No	Name of work	EMD (Rs)	Cost of tender form (Rs) (Incl. GST)	Date of opening
TR-1164 RFX No.- 8100053457	Construction of L1LO of 132 KV DCDS Kondatarai – Jurda (NTPC) line to proposed 132 KV Substation at Raigarh Medical College (RL-2.171 KM)	69,580/-	5,000/-	25.08.2026

For all other details of NIT and terms & conditions, please visit our web site: https://espe.co.in/cspitcl_tendernotices (OR) <https://www.cspc.co.in> e-bidding > e-bidding web portal (OR) <https://ebidding.cspcl.co.in:50724/irj/portal>
EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR (LINE) CSPITCL, Raipur
SAVE ELECTRICITY samvad 48652/1



UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD R and B DIVISION BAKSHI NAGAR JAMMU
Short e-NIT No.49of 2026-2027 Dated:-30-07-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on **percentage basis** from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised Cost (Rs. Lakh)	Cost of document (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Time Allowed for compleateon	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	Supply Installation Testing and Commissioning SITC of Lift and Audio-Visual System for the Conference Hall including Allied Works at Workshop Block A at Govt ITI Jammu.	PWD (R&B) DIVISION BAKSHI NAGAR Jammu	96.03	1500/-	(2% of the Advertised Cost)	60 Days	11-08-2026 (12.00 Pm)	"A"

Position of AAA / TS : Accorded

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen / downloaded from the departmental website <http://jktenders.gov.in> as per below schedule :-

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	31-07-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 31-07-2026 to 10-08-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	
4	Bid submission Start Date	31-07-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	10-08-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	11-08-2026 on or after 1200 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

Special Conditions- The contractor has successfully completed similar work, and the completion certificate shall be issued by an authority not below the rank of Executive Engineer

1. Bids must be accompanied with cost of Tender document in shape of e-challan through Treasury indicating Treasury Voucher No. & date, e-NIT No. and name of work duly crediting to MH 0059 (Revenue) favoring Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu and upload the same i.e treasury challan / receipt, Earnest money/Bid security in shape of CDR/FDR/BG pledged to Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu The CDR/FDR/BG shall be valid for 45 Days beyond the bid validity period. The original instruments in respect of cost of documents, EMD and relevant documents of L1 be submitted to the Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu at the time of allotment.

2. The electronic bidding system would not allow any late submission of bids after due date and time as per server time. Bidders may modify their bids by uploading their request for modification before the deadline for submission of bids. For this, the bidder needs not to make any additional payment towards the cost of tender document. For bid modification and consequential re-submission, the bidder is not required to withdraw his bid submitted earlier. The last modified bid submitted by the bidder within the bid submission time shall be considered as the bid. For this purpose, modification/withdrawal by other means will not be accepted. In online system of bid submission, the modification and consequential- submission of bids is allowed any number of times. The bidders may withdraw his bid by uploading their request before the deadline for submission of bids; however, if the bid is withdrawn, the re-submission of the bid is not allowed. No bid shall be modified or withdrawn after the deadline of submission of bids.

3. The date and time of opening of Financial-Bids shall be notified on Web Site www.jktenders.gov.in and conveyed to the bidders automatically through an e-mail message on their e-mail address. The Financial-bids of responsive bidders shall be opened online in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu The date for same shall be intimated separately.

4. The bids for the work shall remain valid for a period of 120 days from the date of opening of Technical bids.

5. The earnest money shall be forfeited, if:-
a) Any bidder/tenderer withdraws his bid/tender during the period of bid validity or makes any modifications in the terms and conditions of the bid.
b) Failure of Successful bidder to furnish the required performance security within specified time period after issue of letter of acceptance.
c) Failure of successful bidder to execute the agreement on same day of allotment of work contract as per Chief Engineer PW (R&B) Department Jammu's Circular No. CEJ/G/12660-87 dated 07-10-2021.

6. Instruction to bidders regarding e-tendering process.

6.1 Bidders are advised to download bid submission manual from the "Downloads" option as well as from "Bidders Manual Kit" on website www.jktenders.gov.in to acquaint bid submission process.

6.2. To participate in bidding process, bidders have to get "Digital Signature Certificate (DSC)" as per Information Technology Act-2000. Bidders can get digital certificate from any approved vendors.

6.3. The bidders have to submit their bids online in electronic form with digital Signature. No financial bid will be accepted in physical form.

6.4. Bids will be opened online as per time schedule mentioned above.

6.5. Bidders must ensure to upload scanned copy of all necessary documents mentioned in NIT and S&B with technical bid online.
Note:- Scan all the documents on 100 dpi with black and white option.

7. The department will not be responsible for any delay in online submission due to any reasons.

8.Scanned copy of cost of tender document in shape of e-challan through Treasury indicating Treasury Voucher No. & date, e-NIT No. and name of work duly crediting to MH - 0059 (Revenue) favoring Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu and upload the same i.e treasury challan /receipt, Earnest money/Bid security in shape of CDR/FDR/BG pledged to Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu and Correctness of Information on the notarized affidavit which must be notarized between the period of downloading of bidding document as per the format mentioned in the e-NIT/S&B with the technical documents of the bid.

9. Bidders may contact office of the Chief Engineer PW (R&B) Department, Jammu or concerned Executive Engineer for any guidance for getting DSC or any other relevant details in respect of e-tendering process.

No :- EE/R&B /BN/4593-4602
Dated:- 30-07-2026
DIP No:DIP/J-7290/26

Sd/- (ER. SANDEEP GUPTA)
Executive Engineer
PWD (R&B) Division Bakshi Nagar



उद्यान निदेशालय, झांखण्ड, राँची
कृषि भवन, काँके रोड, राँची-834008
(कृषि पशुपालन एवं सहकारिता विभाग)
Email ID-ddhrranchi@rediffmail.com

CORRIGENDUM

E-Tender/Horti/02/26-27 (PR 385991 (Agriculture) 26-27 (D)) for "Supply and installation of Processing Unit/ Components under Processing-cum-Value addition in Horticulture-cum-non timber forest produce of Directorate of Horticulture, Jharkhand, for a period of One year."

1. Pre Bid Meeting हेतु निर्धारित तिथि को 03.08.2026 के स्थान पर 14.08.2026 पढ़ा जाय।

2. Technical Bid Opening हेतु निर्धारित तिथि को 18.08.2026 के स्थान पर 19.08.2026 पढ़ा जाय।

3. Financial Bid Opening हेतु निर्धारित तिथि को 21.08.2026 के स्थान पर 22.08.2026 पढ़ा जाय।

4. प्रकाशित E-Tender की अन्य कड़िकाएँ यथावत समझी जाय।

ह0 / -
निदेशक उद्यान,
झांखण्ड, राँची

PR 386573 Agriculture (26-27)_D

राँची पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय, राँची

सर्वसाधारण के लिए सूचना



नाम-आरती कुमारी, उम्र-23 वर्ष, उँचाई-4 फिट, 3 ईंच, रंग-साँवली, पहनावा-गुलाबी रंग का साड़ी एवं ब्लाउज पहनी हुई है।
उपरोक्त लापता महिला आरती कुमारी, उम्र-23 वर्ष, पति- अजय करमाली, पता-सुभाशनगर, ब्वाटर नं0-242, पो0-डकरा, थाना- खलारी, जिला- राँची, जो एक माह पूर्व अपने घर से बगैर बताए कहीं चली गईं जो आजतक अपने घर वापस नहीं आई है। जिनकी मानसिक स्थिति ठीक नहीं है। जिसके संबंध में खलारी थाना सनहा सं0-12/2026, दिनांक-28.07.2026 दर्ज कर इनकी खोजबीन की जा रही है। उपरोक्त सूचना को सार्वजनिक किया जाना आवश्यक है। अतः सभी जनसाधारण से अनुरोध है कि यदि उपरोक्त लापता महिला कहीं मिलती / दिखती है तो इसके संबंध में वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक के कार्यालय में या निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर संपर्क कर इसकी सूचना दें।
Email ID(mrc-dcb@jhpoliche.gov.in)
पुलिस उपधीक्षक, खलारी, राँची।
थाना प्रभारी, खलारी, राँची।
आवेदिका बरती देवी।

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वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक,
राँची

PR 386656 Police(26-27).D

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Kailash Singh, S/o Munshi Singh R/o Premises near House No. 324, Padarth Panna, Near Pole No. NJFS 105, Village Mitraora, Jaffarpur, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **Case CT Case No. 270/2021 u/s 135 Indian Electricity Act at P.S. Baba Haridas Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Kailash Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Kailash Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **u/s 82 Cr.P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Kailash Singh** accused of **CT Case No. 270/2021 u/s 135 Indian Electricity Act at P.S. Baba Haridas Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **05.09.2026**.

By Order: Ms. Harleen Singh,
Additional District & Sessions Judge (South-West),
Special Court (Electricity), Court No. 609,
Dwarka Court, New Delhi

DP/10827/DW/2026

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
SOIL INVESTIGATION DIVISION, ADVANCE PLANNING, ROAD CONSTRUCTION DEPARTMENT,RANCHI
NirupanBhawan,3rd Floor,Room No. 403,56-Set,Doranda,Ranchi-834002
e-Procurement (National Bidding)
Letter of Invitation (LOI) No.-07/2026-27
3rd Call
e-Tender Ref No.-RCD/SID/AP/RAN/07/2026-27 Date:- 03.08.2026

1	Name Of Work	(1) Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for Construction of High-level Bridge over Damodar River in Ch.-16th Km of Dantu to Kathara Road under Bokaro district including Approach Road, Land Acquisition proposal Ownership details all complete as per latest guidelines, Resettlement and Rehabilitation Proposal, Forest Diversion Proposal and Proposal of Utility Shifting in details etc. under Bokaro District in the State of Jharkhand. (Approx Length 337.00 m) (2) Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for Construction of Aqueduct over Singari Jodia K.M. Memorial Hospital to Fal Mandi Bridge Mahavir Chowk, Chas road in Bokaro including Approach Road, Land Acquisition proposal Ownership details all complete as per latest guidelines, Resettlement and Rehabilitation Proposal, Forest Diversion Proposal and Proposal of Utility Shifting in details etc. under Bokaro District in the State of Jharkhand. (Approx length-04.00 Km) (3) Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for Construction of Aqueduct over Singari Jodia Fal Mandi Mahavir Chowk to Chira Chas in Bokaro district including Approach Road, Land Acquisition proposal Ownership details all complete as per latest guidelines, Resettlement and Rehabilitation Proposal, Forest Diversion Proposal and Proposal of Utility Shifting in details etc. under Bokaro District in the State of Jharkhand. (Approx length-04.00 Km)
2	Period of Completion of Work	60 Days
3	Cost of Tender documents	Rs 10,000/- (Ten Thousand) only. Non refundable Fee.Tender fee will be received through online mode only. The quotations have to deposit a fixed amount of Rs 2,00,000.00(Two Lakh) only as Earnest Money. As per the Departmental Letter no-4652(S) dated 06.10.2023, cost of tender document and Earnest Money Deposit be received in online mode only through e-procurement (http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in) by internet banking/NEFT/RTGS facility as per Standard Operating sistim Procedure (SOP) issued by Information Technology & e-Governance Department, Government of Jharkhand vide letter no- 120 dated 03.10.2023. e-tendering(http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
4	Mode of Bid Submission	06.08.2026,10:30 AM
5	Date/Time of Publication of Tender on Website	22.08.2026 12:00PM
6	Last Date/Time of Bid Submission	22.08.2026 12:00PM
7	Last Date/Time of Submission of Tender Fee & EMD	24.08.2026 12:30 PM
8	Date and Time of Bid opening	120 days
9	Bid validity	Chief Engineer(Communication),Road Construction Department,1 st Floor, Engineer Hostel No-2, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004
10	Bid Submission Address	Executive Engineer, Soil Investigation Division,Advance Planning,RCD, Ranchi Mob-9905606077.
11	Designation and Contact no. of Tender inviting Officer	371202 Road (2025-26) *D & 374114 Road (2025-26)
12	PR No.-	

Note-Only e-Tender shall be accepted.
Sd/-
(Ravi Shankar Pravakar)
Executive Engineer,
Soil Investigation Division, Advance Planning,
Road Construction Department,Ranchi

PR 386615
Road(26-27)D

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82(2) (ii) Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Sanjay @ Bhure S/o Shyam Pal R/o H No. 32, Keshri ka Makan, Kapasia Jhuggi, Pahari No. 1, Taimoor Nagar, New Delhi**, have committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence under **FIR No. 0210/2022 Date 30.05.2022 U/s 377/323 IPC.**, has been registered at **PS: New Friends Colony, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Sanjay @ Bhure** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Sanjay @ Bhure** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Sanjay @ Bhure** of under **FIR No. 0210/2022 Date 30.05.2022 U/s 377/323 IPC.**, Registered at: **PS: New Friends Colony, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vinod Joshi
Ld. ACJM (South East)
Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/10773/SE/2026
(Court Notice)



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No. JHS-N-W-56-26 Date: 31.07.2026

E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of the President of India invite open Tender through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-N-W-56-26 Approx Cost: Rs. 9718628.63/-

Description of work: Provision of S & T work in connection with replacement of Stone Slab bridges by RCC box/slab in Jhansi-Khairair section of Jhansi division. (38 Nos.)

Opening of tender: 28.08.2026 Time 15.00 Earnest Money: Rs. 194400.00/-

Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance: 12 Months Cost of Tender Form: Nil

Tender on line can be submitted upto 15.00 hrs. on 28.08.2026. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in (NORTH CENTRAL RLY/JHANSI DIVISION-S AND T) 1768/26(K)

f North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Sheetal (age 25 year) W/o Dharma R/o Gali No. 0, Milan Vihar, Near Laxmi Niwas Ashram, Jharoda, Wazirabad, North Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 749/2021, U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Wazirabad, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Sheetal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Sheetal** of case **FIR No. 749/2021, U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Wazirabad, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **dated 17.09.2026**.

By Order
Aakash Mohan Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-12
2nd Floor, Room No. 264,
Tis Hazari Courts, New Delhi

DP/10647/N/2026
(Court Matter)



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE No. 17/2026/RS/JHS Date: 31.07.2026

E-Tender Notice

For and on behalf of President of India, the Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (Rolling Stock) North Central Railway, Jhansi invites open tenders through online (E-Tendering) for the following work:

S.N.: 1, Tender No.: JHS-RS-WC-T6-2026-27, Description: Repairing & preventive maintenance of Cab Air Conditioners of Electric Locomotives.

Tender value : ₹ 2,08,82,849.68 Earnest money : ₹ 4,17,700.00

Completion period from the date of issue of LOA.: 24 Months

S.N.: 2, Tender No.: JHS-RS-WC-T7-2026-27, Description: Replacement of defective & rusted pneumatic pipelines of conventional Electric Locomotives.

Tender value : ₹ 27,80,836.50 Earnest money : ₹ 55,600.00

Completion period from the date of issue of LOA.: 18 Months

Closing date of tender: For S. No.: 1 & 2:- 31.08.2026

Note: (1) tenderer will submit the tender online upto 31.08.2026 (15:00 Hrs.). (2) Complete details & for submission of tenders can be seen in Indian Railway website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> 1770/26 (MG)

f North central railways @ CPONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. & 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Tinku, S/o: Neck Ram R/o: Village & Post- Babrala, Tehsil-Gannoor, District-Sambal, UP** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 500/2021, U/s: 498A/406 IPC PS: Badarpur, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Tinku**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Tinku**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Tinku**, of **FIR No. 500/2021, U/s: 498A/406 IPC PS: Badarpur, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.10.2026**.

By Order
Shivangi Vyas
Judicial Magistrate (First Class)
Mahila Court-01 Room No. 506
South East District
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

DP/10687/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Mukesh, S/o: Late O.P. Gaur, R/o: B-1 Avantika, Sector-1, Rohini, Delhi**, has suspect to committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case Reg.No.: 2824/19, U/s: 138 NI Act**, registered at **P.S.: South Rohini, Delhi** and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Mukesh**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Mukesh**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Mukesh, Case Reg.No.: 2824/19, U/s: 138 NI Act**, registered at **P.S.: South Rohini, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms Aakanksha
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North-West Distt, Room No.107
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/10761/RD/2026
(Court Matter)



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. Dy. CEE/PU/CNB/26-27/T-07 Date : 01.08.2026

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer (Project), N.C. Railway, Kanpur for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No. : Dy. CEE/PU/CNB/26-27/T-07 Approx Cost (Rs.) : 79212570.22

Description of work : Design, Supply, Erection, Commissioning & Testing of Balance work of 220 KV 3 phase transmission line From PGCL Mainpuri to 220/132 kV Bhogano GSS.

Earnest Money (Rs.) : 1584300.00 Cost of Tender Form (Rs.) : 00

Date of closing tender : 22.08.2026 Time : 14.00 Hrs.

Date of completion period from issue acceptance letter. : 06 Months

Validity of Tender : 60 days

* Tender on line can be submitted upto to 14:00 hrs on 22.08.2026. * For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in 1773/26 (C)

f North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPONCR



EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Batch No. 17/26 Dated:31.07.2026

For and on behalf of the President of India, the Principal Chief Materials Manager, East Central Railway invites e-tenders for supply of the following items:

S.No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Quantity	Due Date	Due Time
1.	03261140	21 Teeth Shaft Pinion for WAG - 9 Loco	740 Nos.	31.08.26	14:00
2.	07265002	Wider PSC Sleeper for Level Crossing for 60 kg	3715Nos.	31.08.26	14:00
3.	03262780	Brake shoe 35 mm for conventional type of locomotives	27654	07.09.26	14:00
4.	04263672	Overhauling Kit Must Change Item for Brake Cylinder Knorr Bremse	160 Set	24.08.26	14:00
5.	03263642	Set of Outer labyrinth (DE) for 3-ph Traction Motor Set Model No. 6FRA 6088 Consisting of 02 items	565 Set	24.08.26	14:00
6.	03253574A	Modified single duct leather bellow for WAG 9/WAPT 1ccos	1177 Nos.	31.08.26	14:00
7.	0626RCC SSDAC	Running Contract for Supply, Installation and 131 Set Commissioning of Dual Section Digital Axs Counter	131 Set	24.08.26	14:00

Note: All the above-mentioned tenders are e-tenders and all tenderers are requested to submit their bids on-line through the IREPS website at www.ireps.gov.in. All conrgendum to above-mentioned tenders shall also be published online in IREPS website only. For more details regarding the above-mentioned tenders and other supply tenders please visit IREPS website. PR/0659/HQ/Store/T/26-27/64 AMM Cum-Secy to PCMM /ECR/Hajipur



CHANGE OF NAME

I , SUMAYA (Old Name) S/O, D/O, W/O MANJEET KOTWAL R/O H-No-20343 Lower Thather BANTALAB JMU has changed my name from SUMAYA (old name) to SUMAYA FATIMA SHAD (new name).I do hereby assume from this date the name/surname SUMAYA FATIMA SHAD (new name).

I, Rahuf S/o Maroof Ahmed R/o L-222, Band Gali No-12, Gautam Vihar, Garhi Mendu, Delhi-110053 have changed my name to **Rahuf Ahmed**.

COURT NOTICE (U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC) IN THE COURT OF Sh. Jitesh Kumar Sharma Civil Judge (Junior Division), Jhajjar
Rakesh Kumar son of Satbir son of Maan Singh Vs. Surajbhan son of Phool Singh son of Jassu
CNR No. HRJRE02-001791-2025 Next Date 31-10-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO: D2 KULWANT SINGH SON OF NARAYAN SINGH D3 KULBIR S/O NARAYAN D4 KAMLESH D/O NARAYAN D5 VINAY KUMAR S/O PRASHAN D6 VIKAS S/O PRASHAN ALL R/O VILLAGE A KEHARI MADANPUR TEHSIL MATANHAIL AND DISTRICT JHAJJAR
In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **31-10-2026 at 10:00 a.m.**
For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/2mod=sdistrict Notice&district=Jhajjar>
Sd/- Sh. Jitesh Kumar Sharma Civil Judge (Junior Division), Jhajjar

COURT NOTICE (U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC) IN THE COURT OF Ms. Suman Civil Judge (Junior Division) Bahadurgarh
NIHAR RANJAN MOHANTI S/O NATWAR MOHANTI THR. ITS SPECIAL POWER OF ATTORNEY SH. AMIT KUMAR JAIN VS. 1. SATPAL S/O MUNSHI RAM AND ORS.
CS/288/2026 CNR No. HRJRA0-000406-2026 NEXT DATE:- 05-09-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO: Def. 2 Bhanmati W/o Ram Kishan >H.No.110, Village Mongolpur, Near Courtmunity Centre Avntika Delhi
In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on <



‘Real women are contradictory’

Rasika Dugal to reprise her role as Beena Tripathi in ‘Mirzapur: The Movie’

Rasika Dugal is returning to the world of ‘Mirzapur’, reprising her role as the shrewd and much-discussed Beena Tripathi aka Beena Bhabhi in ‘Mirzapur: The Movie’. In a recent interview, the actress opened up about what continues to draw her to the character and how the franchise’s female characters have expanded the way strength and femininity are portrayed on screen.

Beena Tripathi has long divided opinion among ‘Mirzapur’ fans, admired by some for her cunning, criticised by others for her manipulative streak. For Dugal, that very complexity is what makes the character worth revisiting. She told ‘Mid-Day’, “What drew me to Beena is that she refuses to fit into a neat box. She constantly adapts, negotiates power, makes difficult decisions and surprises both the audience and herself. That makes her far more interesting to play than someone who is written to appear ‘strong’ in every scene.”

Dugal added that returning to the character in the film has been especially rewarding: “Revisiting Beena in ‘Mirzapur: The Movie’ has been rewarding because the writing gives audiences the opportunity to see her beyond binaries.”

Dugal also spoke more broadly about how the franchise’s female characters have



pushed back against a singular idea of what a ‘strong woman’ should look like on screen.

She explained, “Strength, by itself, cannot be the only defining trait of a woman. Real women are contradictory. They can be vulnerable one moment and strategic the next; they can be compassionate and make morally questionable choices at the same time.”

‘Mirzapur: The Movie’ marks the franchise’s first theatrical outing, following three successful seasons on ‘Amazon Prime Video’ since the show’s 2018 debut. Directed by Gurmmeet Singh and written by series creator Puneet Krishna, the film brings back the show’s principal cast, including Pankaj Tripathi and Ali Fazal and marks the much-anticipated return of Divyendhu. Rasika Dugal reprises her role as Beena Tripathi, alongside Shweta Tripathi Sharma, Shriya Pilgaonkar, Abhishek Banerjee, Sheeba Chaddha and others. The film is scheduled for a nationwide theatrical release on September 4, 2026, before streaming on ‘Prime Video’ after an eight-week theatrical window.

AGENCIES

Beena Tripathi has long divided opinion among ‘Mirzapur’ fans, admired by some for her cunning, criticised by others for her manipulative streak

I was young and stupid: Dia Mirza

She is to be seen next in Netflix’s ‘Operation: Safed Sagar’

Dia Mirza opened up about how her approach to selecting film roles has evolved over the years. The actress, who has appeared in ‘Alpha’, ‘Ikka’ and will next be seen in ‘Operation Safed Sagar’, said she no longer judges a character by the length of its screen time. Instead, she now focuses on the emotional impact a role brings to the overall story.

Speaking in an interview with ‘News18’, Dia explained that the duration of a role has never been her deciding factor in recent years. According to her, what truly matters is whether the character contributes meaningfully to the narrative.



“Evaluating whether you want to make time and be a part of a story should never be determined by the length of the part,” she said. Elaborating further, she added, “I think it should be determined

The actress said that she once rejected good films over screen time

by the resonance or the truth you find in it. Sometimes, you’re also drawn to the person you’re supposed to play and you believe that you can live that truth the character has to embody.”

Dia plays the wife of Wing Commander Tony Dhanoa in ‘Operation Safed Sagar’, a series based on the Indian Air Force’s Golden Arrows Squadron during the

1999 Kargil War.

She admitted that her outlook was very different when she first entered the film industry. Mirza revealed that she had declined some notable projects because she believed the parts offered to her were too small. Reflecting on those decisions, she said, “In the first five years of my career, I was young and stupid and I was trying to figure my own head out. I may have said no to some really great work because the role wasn’t long enough. But I’ve never done that in the last 20 years of my career.”

AGENCIES



‘NOT AN IMPULSIVE THING’

Ariana addresses her upcoming break

Actress-singer Ariana Grande addressed her decision to step away from the limelight with a career break, saying it was not an impulsive thing. She had announced via her representative that she was taking a break after the end of her ‘Eternal Sunshine Tour’.

Addressing the announcement during her performance in Chicago, the 33-year-old actress said sometimes the news gets blown out of proportion, reported ‘Variety’. “Sometimes when a story comes out that’s not directly from me, things can get a little blown out of proportion. So, I just wanted to speak to my fans directly tonight

The 33-year-old actress said sometimes the news gets blown out of proportion

because I love you so much. The announcement that was made yesterday was not a reactive or impulsive thing,” she said.

“It is something that I had decided to plan that I had quietly made a long time ago and it’s a decision that was made from a thoughtful and empowered place,” she added.

The ‘Wicked’ star said she wanted to address her planned break after she heard that her fans were worried ‘that negativity was ruining things’ for her.

“Honestly, this is not what that is. And I just want to be very, very clear: Multiple things can be true at the same time. Yes, boundaries, they need to be set. Human beings can need a break sometimes. Also, this can be and will continue to be the greatest experience of my professional and creative life,” she added.

The earlier statement shared by the representative said the decision was made due to ‘ongoing public scrutiny’.

Grande’s weight loss over the years has attracted intense media speculation and her current thinness has sparked health concerns for her, with many comparing it to platinum-selling singer Karen Carpenter. Carpenter, 32, died of heart failure brought on by anorexia and bulimia in 1983. PTI

‘Spider-Man: Brand New Day’ beats ‘Avengers: Endgame’ box office record

Spider-Man beat the Avengers at the box office. ‘Spider-Man: Brand New Day’ broke the ‘Avengers: Endgame’ record for the biggest North American opening weekend with 360 million dollars in ticket sales from theatres in the US and Canada, ‘Sony Pictures’ said.

‘Sony’ on Sunday projected that ‘Spider-Man’ would net an estimated 355 million dollars in its first weekend playing in 4,487 theatres, just barely missing the 2019 ‘Avengers: Endgame’ record of 357 million dollars. But the fourth ‘Spider-Man’ movie starring Tom Holland had a stronger-than-expected Sunday and ultimately came in ahead.

Tom Rothman, the chairman and CEO of ‘Sony Pictures Motion Picture Group’ said in a statement on Monday, “Records are made to be broken, but we will take great pride in this one, for



According to ‘Rentrak’, the domestic box office overall is up over 15 per cent from last year

as long as we hold it.”

Before ‘Avengers: Endgame’, no movie had opened over 300 million dollars domestically. The previous record holders were ‘Avengers: Infinity War’, which launched with 257 million dollars in 2018 and ‘Star Wars: The Force Awakens’ (247 million dollars in 2015).

In December 2021, during the pandemic, the third Holland Spider-Man movie ‘No Way Home’, earned a place on the list with a 260 million dollars debut on its way to 1.9 billion dollars globally.

The high-earning combination of ‘Spider-Man: Brand New Day’ and ‘The Odyssey’, which share actors Holland, Zendaya and Jon Bernthal, also propelled a record weekend overall for movie theatres in the US and Canada.

According to ‘Rentrak’, the domestic box office overall is up over 15 per cent from last year with over 6.2 billion dollars in ticket sales to date.

AGENCIES

RAKUL SHARES WHY SHE CHOSE SURPANAKHA IN ‘RAMAYANA’

Although her screen time in the trailer is brief, her casting has generated considerable interest

Director Nitesh Tiwari’s ‘Ramayana’ has dominated online conversations ever since its four-minute trailer was unveiled last week. While the visually ambitious first glimpse has been met with some praise, it has also sparked several debates, from questions around Ranbir Kapoor’s casting as Lord Rama and discussions about the film’s costume design to the surprise appearance of actors like Vivek Oberoi.

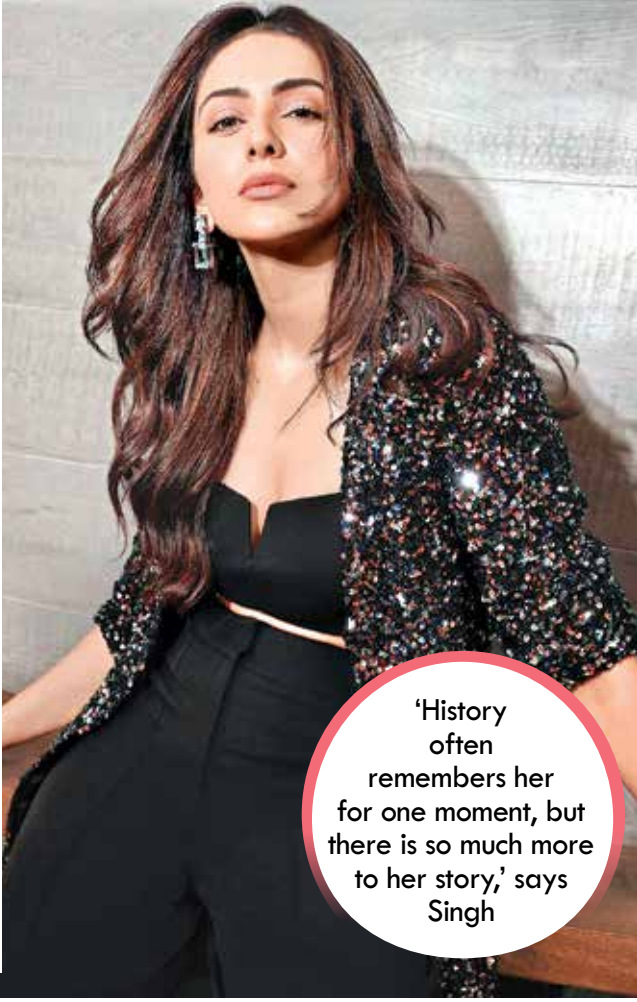
Among the many talking points from the trailer is Rakul Preet Singh, who appears as Surpanakha, the sister of Ravana. Although her screen time in the trailer is brief, her casting has generated considerable interest, with many curious to see her interpretation of one of the epic’s most layered and often misunderstood characters.



Recently, Rakul took to ‘X’ to explain what drew her to the role. Responding to a fan who praised her decision to portray Surpanakha, the actress shared that it was the character’s emotional complexity that convinced her to join the film. She replied, “Thank you for this beautiful letter. What made me say yes to Surpanakha was exactly what you mentioned - her complexity. History often remembers her for one moment, but there is so much more to her story. As an actor, roles that challenge perception are the most exciting. I hope audiences discover her with an open mind when Ramayana arrives.”

Surpanakha is one of the pivotal figures in Valmiki’s ‘Ramayana’, whose actions set in motion the chain of events that ultimately culminated in the war between Lord Ram and Ravana. As the sister of the powerful demon king Ravana, she played a crucial role in shaping the epic’s central conflict.

AGENCIES



‘History often remembers her for one moment, but there is so much more to her story,’ says Singh